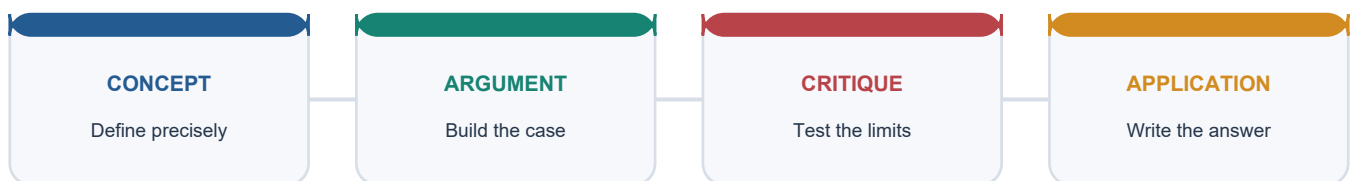


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

IMF, World Bank, ADB, AIIB, NDB and Global Governance - Complete Learning Session

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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IMF, World Bank, ADB, AIIB, NDB and Global Governance - Complete Learning Session

SOURCE, TIMELINE AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

Current-source cutoff: 9 September 2026.

Mandatory source order used

1. Canonical Economy Basic/Core and Optional Advanced Markdown.
2. OCR-searchable *Indian Economy* by Ramesh Singh and *Economic Survey 2025-26*.
3. Official IMF, World Bank Group, ADB, AIIB, NDB, G20, FSB, BIS and Paris Club sources.
4. Qdrant was not required.

Evidence discipline: Membership, leadership, capital, voting power, eligibility and facility status are dated. Authorised capital, subscribed capital, approvals, commitments and disbursements remain separate.

OFFICIAL SOURCE REGISTER

- IMF membership and Liechtenstein: <https://www.imf.org/en/news/articles/2024/10/21/pr-24387-liechtenstein-principality-of-liechtenstein-becomes-imfs-191st-member>
- IMF Managing Director second term: <https://www.imf.org/en/news/articles/2024/04/12/pr24113-imf-executive-board-selects-kristalina-georgieva-to-serve-a-second-term-as-managing-director>
- IMF India quota and voting: <https://www.imf.org/en/about/executive-board/members-quotas>
- IMF Sixteenth General Review status: <https://www.imf.org/en/publications/policy-papers/issues/2026/05/13/extension-of-the-period-for-consent-to-increase-quotas-under-the-sixteenth-general-review-576053>
- IMF SDR basket: <https://www.imf.org/en/news/articles/2022/05/14/pr22153-imf-board-concludes-sdr-valuation-review>
- IMF RFI: <https://www.imf.org/en/about/factsheets/sheets/2023/rapid-financing-instrument-rfi>
- World Bank Group membership/governance: <https://www.worldbank.org/en/about/leadership/members>
- World Bank Group boards: <https://www.worldbank.org/en/about/annual-report/one-world-bank-group>
- World Bank President: <https://www.worldbank.org/en/news/press-release/2023/05/03/ajay-banga-selected-14th-president-of-the-world-bank>
- IDA eligibility: <https://ida.worldbank.org/en/about/borrowing-countries>
- IFC governance: <https://www.ifc.org/en/about/governance-and-financial-sustainability>
- MIGA membership: <https://www.miga.org/member-countries>
- ICSID member-state database: <https://icsid.worldbank.org/about/member-states/database-of-member-states>
- World Bank project cycle: <https://projects.worldbank.org/en/projects-operations/products-and-services/brief/projectcycle>
- World Bank procurement framework: <https://www.worldbank.org/ext/en/what-we-do/project-procurement/framework>
- ADB mandate and membership: <https://www.adb.org/who-we-are/about>
- ADB India facts: <https://www.adb.org/who-we-are/partners/india/overview>
- ADB President: <https://www.adb.org/news/new-adb-president-masato-kanda-assumes-office>
- ADB Nature Solutions Finance Hub: <https://www.adb.org/node/928441/printable/print>
- AIIB membership/voting table: <https://www.aiib.org/en/about-aiib/governance/members-of-bank/index.html>
- AIIB President/current facts: <https://www.aiib.org/en/news-events/news/2026/zou-jiaji-assumes-presidency-asian-infrastructure-investment-bank.html>
- NDB members: <https://www.ndb.int/about-ndb/members/>
- NDB shareholding: <https://www.ndb.int/about-ndb/shareholding/>

- NDB President: <https://www.ndb.int/news/board-of-governors-re-elects-h-e-mrs-dilma-rousseff-as-ndb-president/>
- G20 2026: <https://www.g20.org/about-g20/>
- FSB mandate/governance: <https://www.fsb.org/about/>
- FSB organisation: <https://www.fsb.org/about/organisation-and-governance/>
- BIS members: <https://www.bis.org/about/organisation/members>
- BCBS overview/charter: <https://www.bis.org/committees/bcbs/overview>
- Paris Club principles: <https://clubdeparis.org/en/sites/clubdeparis/accueil/club-de-paris/roles-et-missions.html>

ORIGIN AND TIMELINE

Date	Development	Boundary
July 1944	Bretton Woods conference	Designed IMF and IBRD architecture
December 1945	IMF and IBRD came into existence	Operations followed later
1947	IMF and IBRD began operations	Distinct stabilisation/development mandates
1956 / 1960 / 1966 / 1988	IFC / IDA / ADB / MIGA established	ICSID Convention entered into force in 1966
1999 / 2008	G20 finance forum / leaders' forum	Informal coordination, not treaty government
2009	FSB succeeded the Financial Stability Forum	Standards coordination, no direct legal force
2014-16	NDB and AIIB created and began operations	New MDBs complement older institutions
November 2020	G20 Common Framework agreed	Restructuring beyond DSSI payment suspension
23 August 2021	General SDR allocation effective	SDR 456.5 billion allocated by quota shares
1 August 2022	Current SDR basket weights effective	Next scheduled review in 2027
December 2023	IMF approved 50% equiproportional quota increase	Effectiveness remained conditional
21 October 2024	Liechtenstein became IMF member 191	Dated membership count
24 February 2025	Masato Kanda assumed ADB presidency	Current at cutoff
7 July 2025	Dilma Rousseff's new NDB term began	Runs to 6 July 2030
16 January 2026	Zou Jiayi assumed AIIB presidency	AIIB's tenth anniversary
5 June 2026	Uzbekistan became NDB member	Prospective members remain separate

DATED CURRENT FACT RAIL

Institution/item	Status at 9 September 2026	Qualification
IMF	191 members; Kristalina Georgieva's second term began 1 October 2024	Membership is not equal voting
India at IMF	Quota SDR 13,114.4 million; voting share 2.63%	Quota and vote are distinct
IMF 16th Review	50% equiproportional increase; 149 consents/76.66% by 29 April 2026; 85% needed; deadline 15 November 2026	Not effective at cutoff
SDR basket	USD 43.38%; EUR 29.31%; CNY 12.28%; JPY 7.59%; GBP 7.44%	Effective 1 August 2022; next review 2027
IBRD / IDA	189 IBRD members; 78 IDA-eligible borrowers in FY2027	Membership and eligibility differ
IFC / MIGA / ICSID	186 / 182 members; ICSID 158 Contracting States and 166 signatories in August 2026	India is not an ICSID signatory or Contracting State

Institution/item	Status at 9 September 2026	Qualification
ADB	69 members, 50 regional; Masato Kanda President	Current official page
India at ADB	6.317% shares; 5.343% total votes	Valued at 31 December 2025
AIIB	111 approved members; USD 100 billion authorised capital; Zou Jiayi President	Approved/member accession stages differ
India at AIIB	USD 8,367.3 million subscription; 8.5702% capital; 7.5268% voting power	Live table checked at cutoff
NDB	Ten full members; five prospective; Dilma Rousseff term to 6 July 2030	Prospective is not full membership
India at NDB	USD 10 billion subscription; 18.72% of current subscribed capital	Live table checked at cutoff
BIS / BCBS	BIS 63 central-bank owners; BCBS 45 members from 28 jurisdictions	BCBS standards lack direct legal force
FSB	Andrew Bailey Chair; 59 Plenary representatives from 25 jurisdictions plus institutional/standard-setter seats	Recommendations rely on national implementation
G20	19 countries + EU + AU; US presidency in 2026	Informal, consensus-based, no permanent secretariat

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CORE SESSION 1 - Institution-comparison frame

VISUAL FIRST

INSTITUTION-COMPARISON FRAME

mandate -> client -> instrument -> governance -> conditions -> outcome

BOUNDARY -> Institutional labels do not prove effectiveness; assess additionality, implementation, distribution and repayment.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

International economic institutions must be compared by mandate, client, instrument, governance and conditionality rather than treated as one pool of foreign finance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Institution-comparison frame matters because the same dollar amount can have different economic meaning because a reserve asset, programme loan, project loan, equity investment and guarantee allocate risk differently.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: mandate, client, instrument, governance, conditionality, additionality

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Institution-comparison frame matters because the same dollar amount can have different economic meaning because a reserve asset, programme loan, project loan, equity investment and guarantee allocate risk differently.
- **Named evidence:** The canonical Economy owners distinguish stabilisation finance, sovereign development lending, private investment, guarantees, dispute settlement and standard setting.
- **Analysis:** The same dollar amount can have different economic meaning because a reserve asset, programme loan, project loan, equity investment and guarantee allocate risk differently.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Institutional labels do not prove effectiveness; assess additionality, implementation, distribution and repayment.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The canonical Economy owners distinguish stabilisation finance, sovereign development lending, private investment, guarantees, dispute settlement and standard setting.
- **Analytical inference:** The same dollar amount can have different economic meaning because a reserve asset, programme loan, project loan, equity investment and guarantee allocate risk differently.
- **Qualification:** Institutional labels do not prove effectiveness; assess additionality, implementation, distribution and repayment.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call every international institution a bank or every external resource a loan.

MAINS USE

Use this five-part frame as the introduction to any institution-comparison answer.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: International economic institutions must be compared by mandate, client, instrument, governance and conditionality rather than treated as one pool of foreign finance.
- Evidence anchor: The canonical Economy owners distinguish stabilisation finance, sovereign development lending, private investment, guarantees, dispute settlement and standard setting.
- Verdict: Institution-comparison frame matters because the same dollar amount can have different economic meaning because a reserve asset, programme loan, project loan, equity investment and guarantee allocate risk differently.

CORE SESSION 2 - Bretton Woods origin

VISUAL FIRST

BRETTON WOODS ORIGIN

inter-war instability -> 1944 conference -> IMF/IBRD -> 1945 legal birth -> 1947 operations
BOUNDARY -> The later World Bank Group, floating exchange rates and new MDBs were not fully formed at Bretton Woods.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The 1944 Bretton Woods conference designed a post-war monetary and reconstruction architecture from which the IMF and IBRD emerged.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Bretton Woods origin matters because the design separated short-to-medium-term external stabilisation from long-term reconstruction and development finance.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Bretton Woods, 1944, IMF, IBRD, reconstruction, monetary cooperation

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Bretton Woods origin matters because the design separated short-to-medium-term external stabilisation from long-term reconstruction and development finance.
- **Named evidence:** The IMF and IBRD Articles were negotiated at Bretton Woods in July 1944; both institutions formally came into existence in December 1945.
- **Analysis:** The design separated short-to-medium-term external stabilisation from long-term reconstruction and development finance.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The later World Bank Group, floating exchange rates and new MDBs were not fully formed at Bretton Woods.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The IMF and IBRD Articles were negotiated at Bretton Woods in July 1944; both institutions formally came into existence in December 1945.

- **Analytical inference:** The design separated short-to-medium-term external stabilisation from long-term reconstruction and development finance.
- **Qualification:** The later World Bank Group, floating exchange rates and new MDBs were not fully formed at Bretton Woods.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not say the WTO or all five World Bank Group institutions were created at Bretton Woods.

MAINS USE

Use origin to explain why the IMF and World Bank have different balance-sheet and policy functions.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The 1944 Bretton Woods conference designed a post-war monetary and reconstruction architecture from which the IMF and IBRD emerged.
- Evidence anchor: The IMF and IBRD Articles were negotiated at Bretton Woods in July 1944; both institutions formally came into existence in December 1945.
- Verdict: Bretton Woods origin matters because the design separated short-to-medium-term external stabilisation from long-term reconstruction and development finance.

CORE SESSION 3 - IMF versus World Bank mandate

VISUAL FIRST

IMF VERSUS WORLD BANK MANDATE

external financing gap -> IMF stabilisation | development gap -> World Bank finance

BOUNDARY -> World Bank development-policy finance can support reforms, but it is not identical to IMF crisis lending.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The IMF supports monetary cooperation, surveillance and balance-of-payments adjustment; the World Bank finances development and institutional capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IMF versus World Bank mandate matters because a liquidity or macro-adjustment problem requires different maturity, conditionality and expertise from a road, health or education project.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: balance-of-payments, surveillance, development finance, project lending, policy finance

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IMF versus World Bank mandate matters because a liquidity or macro-adjustment problem requires different maturity, conditionality and expertise from a road, health or education project.
- **Named evidence:** IMF Articles centre on monetary cooperation and exchange stability, while IBRD and IDA lend for reconstruction and development.
- **Analysis:** A liquidity or macro-adjustment problem requires different maturity, conditionality and expertise from a road, health or education project.
- **Qualification / demand link:** World Bank development-policy finance can support reforms, but it is not identical to IMF crisis lending.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF Articles centre on monetary cooperation and exchange stability, while IBRD and IDA lend for reconstruction and development.
- **Analytical inference:** A liquidity or macro-adjustment problem requires different maturity, conditionality and expertise from a road, health or education project.
- **Qualification:** World Bank development-policy finance can support reforms, but it is not identical to IMF crisis lending.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not assign dams and roads as the IMF's primary function.

MAINS USE

Contrast problem, borrower, maturity, instrument and monitoring rather than merely expanding acronyms.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The IMF supports monetary cooperation, surveillance and balance-of-payments adjustment; the World Bank finances development and institutional capacity.
- Evidence anchor: IMF Articles centre on monetary cooperation and exchange stability, while IBRD and IDA lend for reconstruction and development.
- Verdict: IMF versus World Bank mandate matters because a liquidity or macro-adjustment problem requires different maturity, conditionality and expertise from a road, health or education project.

CORE SESSION 4 - International institution is not supranational government

VISUAL FIRST

INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTION IS NOT SUPRANATIONAL GOVERNMENT

member treaty -> delegated mandate -> recommendation/loan condition -> domestic implementation

BOUNDARY -> A binding loan covenant or arbitral award has a specific legal basis and should not be generalised into unlimited authority.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

A multilateral institution acts under treaties, charters and member decisions; it does not possess general sovereign legislative power over member states.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: International institution is not supranational government matters because influence can be powerful through finance, expertise and peer pressure without converting the institution into a world government.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: treaty mandate, member-driven, sovereignty, covenant, national implementation

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** International institution is not supranational government matters because influence can be powerful through finance, expertise and peer pressure without converting the institution into a world government.
- **Named evidence:** IMF Article IV advice, MDB project covenants and FSB standards operate through agreed mandates and national implementation.
- **Analysis:** Influence can be powerful through finance, expertise and peer pressure without converting the institution into a world government.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A binding loan covenant or arbitral award has a specific legal basis and should not be generalised into unlimited authority.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF Article IV advice, MDB project covenants and FSB standards operate through agreed mandates and national implementation.
- **Analytical inference:** Influence can be powerful through finance, expertise and peer pressure without converting the institution into a world government.
- **Qualification:** A binding loan covenant or arbitral award has a specific legal basis and should not be generalised into unlimited authority.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call an institutional recommendation automatically binding domestic law.

MAINS USE

State the source of authority and the domestic implementation channel.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: A multilateral institution acts under treaties, charters and member decisions; it does not possess general sovereign legislative power over member states.
- Evidence anchor: IMF Article IV advice, MDB project covenants and FSB standards operate through agreed mandates and national implementation.
- Verdict: International institution is not supranational government matters because influence can be powerful through finance, expertise and peer pressure without converting the institution into a world government.

CORE SESSION 5 - IMF membership and leadership

VISUAL FIRST

IMF MEMBERSHIP AND LEADERSHIP

membership -> quota -> votes/resources -> surveillance/access

BOUNDARY -> Membership count and officeholder are current facts dated to the 9 September 2026 cutoff.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IMF membership confers participation in surveillance, quota-based governance and access to Fund resources subject to its Articles and policies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IMF membership and leadership matters because near-universal membership gives the IMF broad surveillance reach, while quota-weighted governance prevents one-state-one-vote equality.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: 191 members, Managing Director, quota, surveillance, dated status

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IMF membership and leadership matters because near-universal membership gives the IMF broad surveillance reach, while quota-weighted governance prevents one-state-one-vote equality.
- **Named evidence:** Liechtenstein became the IMF's 191st member on 21 October 2024; Kristalina Georgieva's second five-year term as Managing Director began on 1 October 2024.
- **Analysis:** Near-universal membership gives the IMF broad surveillance reach, while quota-weighted governance prevents one-state-one-vote equality.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Membership count and officeholder are current facts dated to the 9 September 2026 cutoff.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Liechtenstein became the IMF's 191st member on 21 October 2024; Kristalina Georgieva's second five-year term as Managing Director began on 1 October 2024.
- **Analytical inference:** Near-universal membership gives the IMF broad surveillance reach, while quota-weighted governance prevents one-state-one-vote equality.
- **Qualification:** Membership count and officeholder are current facts dated to the 9 September 2026 cutoff.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not confuse universal reach with equal voting power.

MAINS USE

Use dated membership and leadership only as governance context, not as proof of legitimacy.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IMF membership confers participation in surveillance, quota-based governance and access to Fund resources subject to its Articles and policies.
- Evidence anchor: Liechtenstein became the IMF's 191st member on 21 October 2024; Kristalina Georgieva's second five-year term as Managing Director began on 1 October 2024.

- Verdict: IMF membership and leadership matters because near-universal membership gives the IMF broad surveillance reach, while quota-weighted governance prevents one-state-one-vote equality.

CORE SESSION 6 - IMF governance bodies

VISUAL FIRST

IMF GOVERNANCE BODIES

Board of Governors -> Executive Board -> management/staff -> member programme

BOUNDARY -> The International Monetary and Financial Committee advises; it is not the IMF's supreme legal organ.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The Board of Governors holds ultimate authority, while the Executive Board conducts regular business under a Managing Director who chairs it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IMF governance bodies matters because delegation permits continuous decisions, but weighted votes and constituency representation shape voice.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Board of Governors, Executive Board, constituency, Managing Director, IMFC

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IMF governance bodies matters because delegation permits continuous decisions, but weighted votes and constituency representation shape voice.
- **Named evidence:** Each member appoints a Governor; the Executive Board represents members and constituencies and approves surveillance and financing decisions.
- **Analysis:** Delegation permits continuous decisions, but weighted votes and constituency representation shape voice.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The International Monetary and Financial Committee advises; it is not the IMF's supreme legal organ.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Each member appoints a Governor; the Executive Board represents members and constituencies and approves surveillance and financing decisions.
- **Analytical inference:** Delegation permits continuous decisions, but weighted votes and constituency representation shape voice.
- **Qualification:** The International Monetary and Financial Committee advises; it is not the IMF's supreme legal organ.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not describe the Managing Director as a unilateral lender.

MAINS USE

Map legal authority, delegated board power and staff analysis separately.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The Board of Governors holds ultimate authority, while the Executive Board conducts regular business under a Managing Director who chairs it.
- Evidence anchor: Each member appoints a Governor; the Executive Board represents members and constituencies and approves surveillance and financing decisions.
- Verdict: IMF governance bodies matters because delegation permits continuous decisions, but weighted votes and constituency representation shape voice.

CORE SESSION 7 - IMF quota functions

VISUAL FIRST

IMF QUOTA FUNCTIONS

relative position -> quota -> contribution + votes + access + SDR allocation

BOUNDARY -> Exceptional access and basic votes mean quota is influential but not the sole determinant of every decision or loan amount.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

An IMF quota is a member's subscription and a central determinant of contribution, voting power, normal access and share in general SDR allocations.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IMF quota functions matters because quota is simultaneously a funding and governance mechanism, so formula reform changes both capacity and representation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: subscription, quota formula, voting power, access, SDR allocation

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IMF quota functions matters because quota is simultaneously a funding and governance mechanism, so formula reform changes both capacity and representation.
- **Named evidence:** The IMF quotas factsheet links quotas to resources, voting, access and SDR allocations.
- **Analysis:** Quota is simultaneously a funding and governance mechanism, so formula reform changes both capacity and representation.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Exceptional access and basic votes mean quota is influential but not the sole determinant of every decision or loan amount.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The IMF quotas factsheet links quotas to resources, voting, access and SDR allocations.
- **Analytical inference:** Quota is simultaneously a funding and governance mechanism, so formula reform changes both capacity and representation.
- **Qualification:** Exceptional access and basic votes mean quota is influential but not the sole determinant of every decision or loan amount.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not treat quota as a periodic membership fee without governance consequences.

MAINS USE

Explain quota reform through its four functions.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: An IMF quota is a member's subscription and a central determinant of contribution, voting power, normal access and share in general SDR allocations.
- Evidence anchor: The IMF quotas factsheet links quotas to resources, voting, access and SDR allocations.
- Verdict: IMF quota functions matters because quota is simultaneously a funding and governance mechanism, so formula reform changes both capacity and representation.

CORE SESSION 8 - Quota votes and basic votes

VISUAL FIRST

QUOTA VOTES AND BASIC VOTES

basic votes + quota votes → total voting power → board decision

BOUNDARY → A voting share is not identical to quota share because basic votes affect the denominator.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IMF voting combines equal basic votes with quota-based votes, producing limited formal equality within a predominantly weighted system.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Quota votes and basic votes matters because basic votes protect a minimum voice for small members, while quota votes align influence with financial stake and measured economic weight.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: basic votes, quota votes, weighted voting, representation, legitimacy

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Quota votes and basic votes matters because basic votes protect a minimum voice for small members, while quota votes align influence with financial stake and measured economic weight.
- **Named evidence:** IMF governance rules allocate each member basic votes plus one additional vote for each specified portion of quota.
- **Analysis:** Basic votes protect a minimum voice for small members, while quota votes align influence with financial stake and measured economic weight.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A voting share is not identical to quota share because basic votes affect the denominator.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF governance rules allocate each member basic votes plus one additional vote for each specified portion of quota.
- **Analytical inference:** Basic votes protect a minimum voice for small members, while quota votes align influence with financial stake and measured economic weight.
- **Qualification:** A voting share is not identical to quota share because basic votes affect the denominator.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not quote quota share as voting share.

MAINS USE

Use the distinction to assess voice without falsely claiming one-country-one-vote.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IMF voting combines equal basic votes with quota-based votes, producing limited formal equality within a predominantly weighted system.
- Evidence anchor: IMF governance rules allocate each member basic votes plus one additional vote for each specified portion of quota.
- Verdict: Quota votes and basic votes matters because basic votes protect a minimum voice for small members, while quota votes align influence with financial stake and measured economic weight.

CORE SESSION 9 - Sixteenth General Review of Quotas

VISUAL FIRST

SIXTEENTH GENERAL REVIEW OF QUOTAS

2023 resolution -> member consents -> 85% threshold -> effectiveness -> NAB rollback

BOUNDARY -> Approval in 2023 did not itself make the increase effective; the dated consent condition remained pending at the cutoff.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The Sixteenth General Review approved an equiproportional 50 percent quota increase, intended to strengthen quota resources without reallocating relative shares.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Sixteenth General Review of Quotas matters because the increase would shift the resource mix toward quotas, but an equiproportional design does not correct representation gaps.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: 16th GRQ, 50 percent, equiproportional, 85 percent, consent, NAB

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Sixteenth General Review of Quotas matters because the increase would shift the resource mix toward quotas, but an equiproportional design does not correct representation gaps.
- **Named evidence:** An IMF policy paper records 149 consents representing 76.66 percent of quotas by 29 April 2026, below the 85 percent threshold; the consent deadline was extended to 15 November 2026.
- **Analysis:** The increase would shift the resource mix toward quotas, but an equiproportional design does not correct representation gaps.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Approval in 2023 did not itself make the increase effective; the dated consent condition remained pending at the cutoff.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** An IMF policy paper records 149 consents representing 76.66 percent of quotas by 29 April 2026, below the 85 percent threshold; the consent deadline was extended to 15 November 2026.
- **Analytical inference:** The increase would shift the resource mix toward quotas, but an equiproportional design does not correct representation gaps.
- **Qualification:** Approval in 2023 did not itself make the increase effective; the dated consent condition remained pending at the cutoff.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not state that all member quotas had already risen by 50 percent.

MAINS USE

Separate decision, consent threshold, effectiveness and distribution.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The Sixteenth General Review approved an equiproportional 50 percent quota increase, intended to strengthen quota resources without reallocating relative shares.
- **Evidence anchor:** An IMF policy paper records 149 consents representing 76.66 percent of quotas by 29 April 2026, below the 85 percent threshold; the consent deadline was extended to 15 November 2026.
- **Verdict:** Sixteenth General Review of Quotas matters because the increase would shift the resource mix toward quotas, but an equiproportional design does not correct representation gaps.

CORE SESSION 10 - India's IMF quota and vote

VISUAL FIRST

INDIA'S IMF QUOTA AND VOTE

India subscription -> quota share -> basic/quota votes -> voice

BOUNDARY -> The pending equiproportional Sixteenth Review does not by itself raise India's relative share.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

India's current IMF position combines a quota denominated in SDRs with a separately calculated voting share.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: India's IMF quota and vote matters because india's stake gives material voice but remains central to arguments that dynamic emerging economies are under-represented relative to current output.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: India, SDR 13,114.4 million, 2.63 percent, quota reform

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** India's IMF quota and vote matters because india's stake gives material voice but remains central to arguments that dynamic emerging economies are under-represented relative to current output.
- **Named evidence:** The IMF member table checked at the 9 September 2026 cutoff lists India's quota at SDR 13,114.4 million and voting share at 2.63 percent.
- **Analysis:** India's stake gives material voice but remains central to arguments that dynamic emerging economies are under-represented relative to current output.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The pending equiproportional Sixteenth Review does not by itself raise India's relative share.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The IMF member table checked at the 9 September 2026 cutoff lists India's quota at SDR 13,114.4 million and voting share at 2.63 percent.
- **Analytical inference:** India's stake gives material voice but remains central to arguments that dynamic emerging economies are under-represented relative to current output.
- **Qualification:** The pending equiproportional Sixteenth Review does not by itself raise India's relative share.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not convert SDR millions into US dollars without a date-specific SDR value.

MAINS USE

Use India's exact dated figure to ground quota-reform analysis.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: India's current IMF position combines a quota denominated in SDRs with a separately calculated voting share.
- Evidence anchor: The IMF member table checked at the 9 September 2026 cutoff lists India's quota at SDR 13,114.4 million and voting share at 2.63 percent.
- Verdict: India's IMF quota and vote matters because india's stake gives material voice but remains central to arguments that dynamic emerging economies are under-represented relative to current output.

CORE SESSION 11 - Article IV surveillance

VISUAL FIRST

ARTICLE IV SURVEILLANCE

data and mission -> staff assessment -> board discussion -> published report

BOUNDARY -> Advice is not an IMF programme condition unless linked through a separate financing arrangement.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Article IV consultation is the IMF's regular bilateral assessment of a member's macroeconomic, financial and exchange-rate policies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Article IV surveillance matters because surveillance can identify risks and improve transparency without supplying financing.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Article IV, bilateral surveillance, staff report, Executive Board, advice

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Article IV surveillance matters because surveillance can identify risks and improve transparency without supplying financing.
- **Named evidence:** IMF surveillance practice generally conducts consultations annually, with timing adapted to country circumstances.
- **Analysis:** Surveillance can identify risks and improve transparency without supplying financing.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Advice is not an IMF programme condition unless linked through a separate financing arrangement.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF surveillance practice generally conducts consultations annually, with timing adapted to country circumstances.
- **Analytical inference:** Surveillance can identify risks and improve transparency without supplying financing.
- **Qualification:** Advice is not an IMF programme condition unless linked through a separate financing arrangement.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not say every Article IV consultation is a bailout.

MAINS USE

Distinguish diagnosis and advice from lending and conditionality.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Article IV consultation is the IMF's regular bilateral assessment of a member's macroeconomic, financial and exchange-rate policies.
- Evidence anchor: IMF surveillance practice generally conducts consultations annually, with timing adapted to country circumstances.
- Verdict: Article IV surveillance matters because surveillance can identify risks and improve transparency without supplying financing.

CORE SESSION 12 - Multilateral surveillance

VISUAL FIRST

MULTILATERAL SURVEILLANCE

country policies -> spillovers -> global outlook -> collective risk response

BOUNDARY -> Forecasts are conditional projections, not guaranteed outcomes or binding instructions.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Multilateral surveillance assesses cross-border spillovers and the stability of the international monetary system rather than one member alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Multilateral surveillance matters because system-wide analysis can reveal synchronized risks that bilateral reports miss.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: WEO, GFSR, Fiscal Monitor, spillover, global surveillance

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Multilateral surveillance matters because system-wide analysis can reveal synchronized risks that bilateral reports miss.
- **Named evidence:** The IMF's World Economic Outlook, Global Financial Stability Report and Fiscal Monitor are recurring multilateral-surveillance outputs.
- **Analysis:** System-wide analysis can reveal synchronized risks that bilateral reports miss.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Forecasts are conditional projections, not guaranteed outcomes or binding instructions.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The IMF's World Economic Outlook, Global Financial Stability Report and Fiscal Monitor are recurring multilateral-surveillance outputs.
- **Analytical inference:** System-wide analysis can reveal synchronized risks that bilateral reports miss.
- **Qualification:** Forecasts are conditional projections, not guaranteed outcomes or binding instructions.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not mix an IMF forecast with an official Indian estimate without naming source and period.

MAINS USE

Use multilateral surveillance for spillovers, fragmentation and policy-coordination questions.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Multilateral surveillance assesses cross-border spillovers and the stability of the international monetary system rather than one member alone.
- Evidence anchor: The IMF's World Economic Outlook, Global Financial Stability Report and Fiscal Monitor are recurring multilateral-surveillance outputs.
- Verdict: Multilateral surveillance matters because system-wide analysis can reveal synchronized risks that bilateral reports miss.

CORE SESSION 13 - Financial Sector Assessment Program

VISUAL FIRST

FINANCIAL SECTOR ASSESSMENT PROGRAM

system data -> stress/risk assessment -> standards review -> recommendations

BOUNDARY -> FSAP recommendations require national implementation and are not the same as BCBS rules or an IMF loan.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The FSAP is an IMF-World Bank assessment framework for financial-sector resilience and development, with roles varying by country type and issue.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Financial Sector Assessment Program matters because a joint diagnostic can connect macro-financial vulnerabilities with institutional and developmental constraints.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: FSAP, financial stability, development, standards, stress assessment

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Financial Sector Assessment Program matters because a joint diagnostic can connect macro-financial vulnerabilities with institutional and developmental constraints.
- **Named evidence:** IMF and World Bank material links FSAPs to financial stability, development needs and observance of standards.
- **Analysis:** A joint diagnostic can connect macro-financial vulnerabilities with institutional and developmental constraints.
- **Qualification / demand link:** FSAP recommendations require national implementation and are not the same as BCBS rules or an IMF loan.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF and World Bank material links FSAPs to financial stability, development needs and observance of standards.
- **Analytical inference:** A joint diagnostic can connect macro-financial vulnerabilities with institutional and developmental constraints.
- **Qualification:** FSAP recommendations require national implementation and are not the same as BCBS rules or an IMF loan.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call FSAP a financing facility.

MAINS USE

Use it to connect surveillance, standards and domestic supervisory reform.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The FSAP is an IMF-World Bank assessment framework for financial-sector resilience and development, with roles varying by country type and issue.
- Evidence anchor: IMF and World Bank material links FSAPs to financial stability, development needs and observance of standards.
- Verdict: Financial Sector Assessment Program matters because a joint diagnostic can connect macro-financial vulnerabilities with institutional and developmental constraints.

CORE SESSION 14 - IMF lending architecture

VISUAL FIRST

IMF LENDING ARCHITECTURE

need and eligibility -> facility -> access -> conditionality -> review/disbursement

BOUNDARY -> Access limits, charges and maturities change and must be taken from a dated factsheet.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IMF financial support is organised by resource account, borrower eligibility, balance-of-payments need, maturity and conditionality.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IMF lending architecture matters because facility choice should match the shock's duration, structural depth and repayment capacity.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: GRA, PRGT, RST, eligibility, maturity, access

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IMF lending architecture matters because facility choice should match the shock's duration, structural depth and repayment capacity.
- **Named evidence:** General Resources Account facilities serve the membership broadly; Poverty Reduction and Growth Trust facilities provide concessional support to eligible low-income countries; the Resilience and Sustainability Trust has a longer-horizon resilience mandate.
- **Analysis:** Facility choice should match the shock's duration, structural depth and repayment capacity.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Access limits, charges and maturities change and must be taken from a dated factsheet.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** General Resources Account facilities serve the membership broadly; Poverty Reduction and Growth Trust facilities provide concessional support to eligible low-income countries; the Resilience and Sustainability Trust has a longer-horizon resilience mandate.
- **Analytical inference:** Facility choice should match the shock's duration, structural depth and repayment capacity.
- **Qualification:** Access limits, charges and maturities change and must be taken from a dated factsheet.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not treat RFI, RCF, SBA, EFF and RSF as interchangeable acronyms.

MAINS USE

Classify the resource pool before discussing conditions.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IMF financial support is organised by resource account, borrower eligibility, balance-of-payments need, maturity and conditionality.
- Evidence anchor: General Resources Account facilities serve the membership broadly; Poverty Reduction and Growth Trust facilities provide concessional support to eligible low-income countries; the Resilience and Sustainability Trust has a longer-horizon resilience mandate.
- Verdict: IMF lending architecture matters because facility choice should match the shock's duration, structural depth and repayment capacity.

CORE SESSION 15 - IMF resource layers

VISUAL FIRST

IMF RESOURCE LAYERS

quotas -> NAB -> bilateral borrowing -> lending capacity

BOUNDARY -> Committed borrowing capacity is not identical to disbursed programme credit.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The IMF finances lending through quota resources supplemented by standing borrowing arrangements and, when activated, bilateral borrowed resources.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IMF resource layers matters because a stronger quota base can improve permanence and legitimacy relative to reliance on creditor coalitions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: quota resources, NAB, bilateral borrowing, lending capacity, permanence

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IMF resource layers matters because a stronger quota base can improve permanence and legitimacy relative to reliance on creditor coalitions.
- **Named evidence:** The Sixteenth Review links a 50 percent quota increase to a planned rollback of New Arrangements to Borrow resources.
- **Analysis:** A stronger quota base can improve permanence and legitimacy relative to reliance on creditor coalitions.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Committed borrowing capacity is not identical to disbursed programme credit.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The Sixteenth Review links a 50 percent quota increase to a planned rollback of New Arrangements to Borrow resources.
- **Analytical inference:** A stronger quota base can improve permanence and legitimacy relative to reliance on creditor coalitions.
- **Qualification:** Committed borrowing capacity is not identical to disbursed programme credit.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not add quotas, NAB and bilateral lines as if all were simultaneously cash on loan.

MAINS USE

Use resource composition to analyse adequacy and governance.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The IMF finances lending through quota resources supplemented by standing borrowing arrangements and, when activated, bilateral borrowed resources.
- Evidence anchor: The Sixteenth Review links a 50 percent quota increase to a planned rollback of New Arrangements to Borrow resources.
- Verdict: IMF resource layers matters because a stronger quota base can improve permanence and legitimacy relative to reliance on creditor coalitions.

CORE SESSION 16 - Stand-By Arrangement

VISUAL FIRST

STAND-BY ARRANGEMENT

short-term gap -> SBA approval -> performance tests -> reviews -> tranches

BOUNDARY -> Precautionary treatment is possible; an approved amount need not all be drawn.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

A Stand-By Arrangement supports short-term or potential balance-of-payments needs through phased access under an agreed programme.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Stand-By Arrangement matters because phasing links disbursement to policy implementation and continuing need.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: SBA, phased access, precautionary, programme review, external gap

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Stand-By Arrangement matters because phasing links disbursement to policy implementation and continuing need.
- **Named evidence:** IMF facility guidance identifies the SBA as the Fund's traditional instrument for emerging and advanced economies facing actual or potential external financing needs.
- **Analysis:** Phasing links disbursement to policy implementation and continuing need.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Precautionary treatment is possible; an approved amount need not all be drawn.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF facility guidance identifies the SBA as the Fund's traditional instrument for emerging and advanced economies facing actual or potential external financing needs.
- **Analytical inference:** Phasing links disbursement to policy implementation and continuing need.
- **Qualification:** Precautionary treatment is possible; an approved amount need not all be drawn.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call every SBA a single emergency disbursement.

MAINS USE

Contrast programme reviews with the rapid instruments.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: A Stand-By Arrangement supports short-term or potential balance-of-payments needs through phased access under an agreed programme.
- Evidence anchor: IMF facility guidance identifies the SBA as the Fund's traditional instrument for emerging and advanced economies facing actual or potential external financing needs.
- Verdict: Stand-By Arrangement matters because phasing links disbursement to policy implementation and continuing need.

CORE SESSION 17 - Extended Fund Facility

VISUAL FIRST

EXTENDED FUND FACILITY

structural constraint -> extended programme -> reforms -> reviews -> repayment

BOUNDARY -> Longer maturity does not remove conditionality or the need for debt sustainability.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The Extended Fund Facility supports countries with serious medium-term balance-of-payments problems rooted in structural weaknesses.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Extended Fund Facility matters because longer horizons can match reforms whose payoff and adjustment take time.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: EFF, structural reform, medium term, reviews, debt sustainability

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Extended Fund Facility matters because longer horizons can match reforms whose payoff and adjustment take time.
- **Named evidence:** IMF facility guidance distinguishes the EFF's longer engagement and structural reform orientation from the shorter SBA.
- **Analysis:** Longer horizons can match reforms whose payoff and adjustment take time.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Longer maturity does not remove conditionality or the need for debt sustainability.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF facility guidance distinguishes the EFF's longer engagement and structural reform orientation from the shorter SBA.
- **Analytical inference:** Longer horizons can match reforms whose payoff and adjustment take time.
- **Qualification:** Longer maturity does not remove conditionality or the need for debt sustainability.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not reduce the EFF to ordinary long-term development-project finance.

MAINS USE

Use it where the external gap reflects deep structural imbalance.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The Extended Fund Facility supports countries with serious medium-term balance-of-payments problems rooted in structural weaknesses.
- Evidence anchor: IMF facility guidance distinguishes the EFF's longer engagement and structural reform orientation from the shorter SBA.
- Verdict: Extended Fund Facility matters because longer horizons can match reforms whose payoff and adjustment take time.

CORE SESSION 18 - Rapid Financing Instrument and Rapid Credit Facility

VISUAL FIRST

RAPID FINANCING INSTRUMENT AND RAPID CREDIT FACILITY

urgent shock -> rapid assessment -> single disbursement -> policy cooperation

BOUNDARY -> Rapid access is not unconditional money; qualification, need, safeguards and repayment rules remain.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

RFI and RCF provide rapid support for urgent balance-of-payments needs, with RCF reserved for PRGT-eligible low-income countries.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Rapid Financing Instrument and Rapid Credit Facility matters because speed helps disaster or shock response where a full programme is unnecessary or infeasible.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: RFI, RCF, urgent need, single disbursement, PRGT

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Rapid Financing Instrument and Rapid Credit Facility matters because speed helps disaster or shock response where a full programme is unnecessary or infeasible.
- **Named evidence:** IMF factsheets distinguish the GRA-based RFI from the concessional PRGT-based RCF and describe limited ex-post programme conditionality.
- **Analysis:** Speed helps disaster or shock response where a full programme is unnecessary or infeasible.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Rapid access is not unconditional money; qualification, need, safeguards and repayment rules remain.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF factsheets distinguish the GRA-based RFI from the concessional PRGT-based RCF and describe limited ex-post programme conditionality.
- **Analytical inference:** Speed helps disaster or shock response where a full programme is unnecessary or infeasible.
- **Qualification:** Rapid access is not unconditional money; qualification, need, safeguards and repayment rules remain.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not describe RFI and RCF as identical windows for all members.

MAINS USE

State resource account, eligibility and disbursement structure.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: RFI and RCF provide rapid support for urgent balance-of-payments needs, with RCF reserved for PRGT-eligible low-income countries.
- Evidence anchor: IMF factsheets distinguish the GRA-based RFI from the concessional PRGT-based RCF and describe limited ex-post programme conditionality.
- Verdict: Rapid Financing Instrument and Rapid Credit Facility matters because speed helps disaster or shock response where a full programme is unnecessary or infeasible.

CORE SESSION 19 - Concessional IMF facilities

VISUAL FIRST

CONCESSIONAL IMF FACILITIES

low-income eligibility -> protracted/short/urgent need -> ECF/SCF/RCF

BOUNDARY -> Eligibility and interest terms are policy variables that must be dated.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The ECF, SCF and RCF are PRGT instruments for eligible low-income countries with different duration and programme structures.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Concessional IMF facilities matters because concessional terms address capacity constraints, while facility design still differentiates persistent, short-term and urgent needs.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: ECF, SCF, RCF, PRGT, concessional, low-income

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Concessional IMF facilities matters because concessional terms address capacity constraints, while facility design still differentiates persistent, short-term and urgent needs.
- **Named evidence:** IMF lending architecture distinguishes the Extended Credit Facility, Standby Credit Facility and Rapid Credit Facility.
- **Analysis:** Concessional terms address capacity constraints, while facility design still differentiates persistent, short-term and urgent needs.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Eligibility and interest terms are policy variables that must be dated.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF lending architecture distinguishes the Extended Credit Facility, Standby Credit Facility and Rapid Credit Facility.
- **Analytical inference:** Concessional terms address capacity constraints, while facility design still differentiates persistent, short-term and urgent needs.
- **Qualification:** Eligibility and interest terms are policy variables that must be dated.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not expand ECF as the non-concessional Extended Fund Facility.

MAINS USE

Use the ECF-EFF and RCF-RFI contrasts as close-option controls.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The ECF, SCF and RCF are PRGT instruments for eligible low-income countries with different duration and programme structures.
- Evidence anchor: IMF lending architecture distinguishes the Extended Credit Facility, Standby Credit Facility and Rapid Credit Facility.
- Verdict: Concessional IMF facilities matters because concessional terms address capacity constraints, while facility design still differentiates persistent, short-term and urgent needs.

CORE SESSION 20 - Resilience and Sustainability Facility

VISUAL FIRST

RESILIENCE AND SUSTAINABILITY FACILITY

long-horizon vulnerability -> reform package -> RSF financing -> resilience

BOUNDARY -> It is not a general climate project fund and depends on eligibility and programme conditions.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The RSF provides longer-term financing for reforms that reduce macro-critical risks from climate change and pandemic preparedness.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Resilience and Sustainability Facility matters because it extends IMF support beyond immediate liquidity while retaining a macro-critical link.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: RST, RSF, climate risk, pandemic preparedness, macro-critical

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Resilience and Sustainability Facility matters because it extends IMF support beyond immediate liquidity while retaining a macro-critical link.
- **Named evidence:** The IMF created the Resilience and Sustainability Trust in 2022 and lends through the RSF alongside a qualifying upper-credit-tranche-quality programme.
- **Analysis:** It extends IMF support beyond immediate liquidity while retaining a macro-critical link.
- **Qualification / demand link:** It is not a general climate project fund and depends on eligibility and programme conditions.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The IMF created the Resilience and Sustainability Trust in 2022 and lends through the RSF alongside a qualifying upper-credit-tranche-quality programme.
- **Analytical inference:** It extends IMF support beyond immediate liquidity while retaining a macro-critical link.
- **Qualification:** It is not a general climate project fund and depends on eligibility and programme conditions.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not substitute RSF for MDB project finance.

MAINS USE

Use RSF to show the evolving IMF mandate without erasing its stabilisation core.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The RSF provides longer-term financing for reforms that reduce macro-critical risks from climate change and pandemic preparedness.
- Evidence anchor: The IMF created the Resilience and Sustainability Trust in 2022 and lends through the RSF alongside a qualifying upper-credit-tranche-quality programme.
- Verdict: Resilience and Sustainability Facility matters because it extends IMF support beyond immediate liquidity while retaining a macro-critical link.

CORE SESSION 21 - IMF conditionality toolkit

VISUAL FIRST

IMF CONDITIONALITY TOOLKIT

programme objective -> policy measure -> monitored target -> review -> tranche

BOUNDARY -> Too many or poorly sequenced conditions can weaken ownership and impose avoidable social cost.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Conditionality links financing to policy actions through prior actions, quantitative performance criteria, indicative targets, structural benchmarks and programme reviews.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IMF conditionality toolkit matters because monitoring reduces lender risk and can anchor adjustment expectations.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: prior action, performance criterion, benchmark, review, ownership

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IMF conditionality toolkit matters because monitoring reduces lender risk and can anchor adjustment expectations.
- **Named evidence:** IMF guidance describes conditionality as a safeguard for Fund resources and a means to restore external viability.
- **Analysis:** Monitoring reduces lender risk and can anchor adjustment expectations.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Too many or poorly sequenced conditions can weaken ownership and impose avoidable social cost.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF guidance describes conditionality as a safeguard for Fund resources and a means to restore external viability.
- **Analytical inference:** Monitoring reduces lender risk and can anchor adjustment expectations.
- **Qualification:** Too many or poorly sequenced conditions can weaken ownership and impose avoidable social cost.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call every IMF recommendation a binding condition.

MAINS USE

Name the condition type and connect it to the programme objective.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Conditionality links financing to policy actions through prior actions, quantitative performance criteria, indicative targets, structural benchmarks and programme reviews.
- Evidence anchor: IMF guidance describes conditionality as a safeguard for Fund resources and a means to restore external viability.
- Verdict: IMF conditionality toolkit matters because monitoring reduces lender risk and can anchor adjustment expectations.

CORE SESSION 22 - Programme reviews and disbursement

VISUAL FIRST

PROGRAMME REVIEWS AND DISBURSEMENT

approval -> first purchase -> performance -> review -> later purchase

BOUNDARY -> Board approval is not the same as full disbursement.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

In programme arrangements, approved access is normally phased and subsequent purchases depend on reviews, waivers and observance of agreed conditions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Programme reviews and disbursement matters because phasing creates accountability but can intensify uncertainty if targets become unrealistic after a shock.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: phasing, tranche, review, waiver, disbursement, outstanding credit

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Programme reviews and disbursement matters because phasing creates accountability but can intensify uncertainty if targets become unrealistic after a shock.
- **Named evidence:** SBA and EFF programme documents distinguish total approved access from amounts actually made available after reviews.
- **Analysis:** Phasing creates accountability but can intensify uncertainty if targets become unrealistic after a shock.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Board approval is not the same as full disbursement.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** SBA and EFF programme documents distinguish total approved access from amounts actually made available after reviews.
- **Analytical inference:** Phasing creates accountability but can intensify uncertainty if targets become unrealistic after a shock.
- **Qualification:** Board approval is not the same as full disbursement.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not report an approved envelope as money already received.

MAINS USE

Track approval, availability, purchase and outstanding credit separately.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: In programme arrangements, approved access is normally phased and subsequent purchases depend on reviews, waivers and observance of agreed conditions.
- Evidence anchor: SBA and EFF programme documents distinguish total approved access from amounts actually made available after reviews.
- Verdict: Programme reviews and disbursement matters because phasing creates accountability but can intensify uncertainty if targets become unrealistic after a shock.

CORE SESSION 23 - Conditionality and policy ownership

VISUAL FIRST

CONDITIONALITY AND POLICY OWNERSHIP

diagnosis -> domestic choice -> credible measures -> social protection -> implementation

BOUNDARY -> Domestic ownership cannot excuse opaque targets, distributional harm or misuse of funds.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Policy ownership means domestic authorities understand, choose and can implement the adjustment programme rather than merely complying with an external checklist.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Conditionality and policy ownership matters because ownership can improve compliance and durability, while independent scrutiny protects against weak diagnosis.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: ownership, parsimony, criticality, sequencing, social protection

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Conditionality and policy ownership matters because ownership can improve compliance and durability, while independent scrutiny protects against weak diagnosis.
- **Named evidence:** IMF programme design guidance emphasises parsimony, criticality and national ownership.
- **Analysis:** Ownership can improve compliance and durability, while independent scrutiny protects against weak diagnosis.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Domestic ownership cannot excuse opaque targets, distributional harm or misuse of funds.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF programme design guidance emphasises parsimony, criticality and national ownership.
- **Analytical inference:** Ownership can improve compliance and durability, while independent scrutiny protects against weak diagnosis.
- **Qualification:** Domestic ownership cannot excuse opaque targets, distributional harm or misuse of funds.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not frame conditionality as either pure coercion or automatic discipline.

MAINS USE

Evaluate necessity, sequencing, distribution and democratic accountability.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Policy ownership means domestic authorities understand, choose and can implement the adjustment programme rather than merely complying with an external checklist.
- Evidence anchor: IMF programme design guidance emphasises parsimony, criticality and national ownership.
- Verdict: Conditionality and policy ownership matters because ownership can improve compliance and durability, while independent scrutiny protects against weak diagnosis.

CORE SESSION 24 - Reserve tranche position

VISUAL FIRST

RESERVE TRANCHE POSITION

quota contribution -> IMF use of currency -> reserve claim -> on-demand drawing

BOUNDARY -> Its size changes with IMF transactions and should not be equated to the full quota.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

A reserve tranche position is a member's liquid claim on the IMF arising when the Fund's holdings of its currency are below quota.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Reserve tranche position matters because drawing it is closer to using one's reserve claim than taking a new conditional IMF loan.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: reserve tranche position, liquid claim, quota, reserve asset, unconditional

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Reserve tranche position matters because drawing it is closer to using one's reserve claim than taking a new conditional IMF loan.
- **Named evidence:** The reserve tranche position is recorded as an official reserve asset and can generally be drawn without programme conditionality.
- **Analysis:** Drawing it is closer to using one's reserve claim than taking a new conditional IMF loan.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Its size changes with IMF transactions and should not be equated to the full quota.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The reserve tranche position is recorded as an official reserve asset and can generally be drawn without programme conditionality.
- **Analytical inference:** Drawing it is closer to using one's reserve claim than taking a new conditional IMF loan.
- **Qualification:** Its size changes with IMF transactions and should not be equated to the full quota.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not treat the reserve tranche as a credit facility.

MAINS USE

Use it to separate reserve assets from IMF borrowing.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** A reserve tranche position is a member's liquid claim on the IMF arising when the Fund's holdings of its currency are below quota.
- **Evidence anchor:** The reserve tranche position is recorded as an official reserve asset and can generally be drawn without programme conditionality.
- **Verdict:** Reserve tranche position matters because drawing it is closer to using one's reserve claim than taking a new conditional IMF loan.

CORE SESSION 25 - Gold tranche terminology

VISUAL FIRST

GOLD TRANCHE TERMINOLOGY

pre-1978 gold subscription -> reserve portion -> modern RTP terminology

BOUNDARY -> Modern reserve assets are not defined by a current gold payment requirement.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Gold tranche is the historical expression associated with the modern reserve tranche position, not an additional parallel IMF facility.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Gold tranche terminology matters because terminological history explains why a reserve claim may appear under two names.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: gold tranche, reserve tranche, historical term, reserve asset

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Gold tranche terminology matters because terminological history explains why a reserve claim may appear under two names.
- **Named evidence:** The routed 2020 Prelims demand tests the relationship between the old gold-tranche label and the reserve tranche.
- **Analysis:** Terminological history explains why a reserve claim may appear under two names.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Modern reserve assets are not defined by a current gold payment requirement.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The routed 2020 Prelims demand tests the relationship between the old gold-tranche label and the reserve tranche.
- **Analytical inference:** Terminological history explains why a reserve claim may appear under two names.
- **Qualification:** Modern reserve assets are not defined by a current gold payment requirement.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not count gold tranche and reserve tranche as two facilities.

MAINS USE

State the historical synonym and current accounting treatment.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** Gold tranche is the historical expression associated with the modern reserve tranche position, not an additional parallel IMF facility.
- **Evidence anchor:** The routed 2020 Prelims demand tests the relationship between the old gold-tranche label and the reserve tranche.
- **Verdict:** Gold tranche terminology matters because terminological history explains why a reserve claim may appear under two names.

CORE SESSION 26 - Special Drawing Right

VISUAL FIRST

SPECIAL DRAWING RIGHT

IMF allocation -> member SDR holding -> exchange/use -> reserve position

BOUNDARY -> The SDR is neither retail money nor a claim on the IMF itself; it is a potential claim on freely usable currencies.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The SDR is an IMF-created international reserve asset and unit of account whose value is based on a basket of five currencies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Special Drawing Right matters because sDRs supplement reserves and can be exchanged for freely usable currency among participants.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: SDR, reserve asset, unit of account, freely usable currency, basket

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Special Drawing Right matters because sDRs supplement reserves and can be exchanged for freely usable currency among participants.
- **Named evidence:** The current basket contains the US dollar, euro, Chinese renminbi, Japanese yen and pound sterling.
- **Analysis:** SDRs supplement reserves and can be exchanged for freely usable currency among participants.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The SDR is neither retail money nor a claim on the IMF itself; it is a potential claim on freely usable currencies.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The current basket contains the US dollar, euro, Chinese renminbi, Japanese yen and pound sterling.
- **Analytical inference:** SDRs supplement reserves and can be exchanged for freely usable currency among participants.
- **Qualification:** The SDR is neither retail money nor a claim on the IMF itself; it is a potential claim on freely usable currencies.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call SDR a global currency circulating among households.

MAINS USE

Define its asset, accounting and exchange roles separately.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The SDR is an IMF-created international reserve asset and unit of account whose value is based on a basket of five currencies.
- **Evidence anchor:** The current basket contains the US dollar, euro, Chinese renminbi, Japanese yen and pound sterling.
- **Verdict:** Special Drawing Right matters because sDRs supplement reserves and can be exchanged for freely usable currency among participants.

CORE SESSION 27 - SDR allocation

VISUAL FIRST

SDR ALLOCATION

global long-term reserve need -> 85% approval -> quota-proportionate allocation

BOUNDARY -> It is not targeted by need, creates an equal allocation and liability entry, and using acquired SDRs can involve charges.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

A general SDR allocation distributes newly created SDRs to participants broadly in proportion to IMF quota shares.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: SDR allocation matters because allocation can add reserve liquidity without a country-specific loan negotiation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: general allocation, quota proportion, reserve liquidity, holdings, allocations

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** SDR allocation matters because allocation can add reserve liquidity without a country-specific loan negotiation.
- **Named evidence:** The IMF made a general allocation of SDR 456.5 billion effective 23 August 2021.
- **Analysis:** Allocation can add reserve liquidity without a country-specific loan negotiation.
- **Qualification / demand link:** It is not targeted by need, creates an equal allocation and liability entry, and using acquired SDRs can involve charges.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The IMF made a general allocation of SDR 456.5 billion effective 23 August 2021.
- **Analytical inference:** Allocation can add reserve liquidity without a country-specific loan negotiation.
- **Qualification:** It is not targeted by need, creates an equal allocation and liability entry, and using acquired SDRs can involve charges.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not record an SDR allocation as free fiscal revenue.

MAINS USE

Use allocation design to discuss unequal distribution and rechannelling.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: A general SDR allocation distributes newly created SDRs to participants broadly in proportion to IMF quota shares.
- Evidence anchor: The IMF made a general allocation of SDR 456.5 billion effective 23 August 2021.
- Verdict: SDR allocation matters because allocation can add reserve liquidity without a country-specific loan negotiation.

CORE SESSION 28 - SDR valuation basket

VISUAL FIRST

SDR VALUATION BASKET

five-currency basket -> fixed amounts -> daily exchange rates -> SDR value

BOUNDARY -> Weights are not the same as the fixed currency amounts used in daily valuation, and the dollar value changes daily.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The SDR's daily value is calculated from fixed currency amounts derived from reviewed basket weights and market exchange rates.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: SDR valuation basket matters because a diversified basket reduces dependence on one currency for the unit of account.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: valuation basket, USD, euro, renminbi, yen, sterling, daily value

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** SDR valuation basket matters because a diversified basket reduces dependence on one currency for the unit of account.
- **Named evidence:** Weights effective 1 August 2022 are US dollar 43.38%, euro 29.31%, renminbi 12.28%, yen 7.59% and sterling 7.44%; the next review is scheduled for 2027.
- **Analysis:** A diversified basket reduces dependence on one currency for the unit of account.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Weights are not the same as the fixed currency amounts used in daily valuation, and the dollar value changes daily.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Weights effective 1 August 2022 are US dollar 43.38%, euro 29.31%, renminbi 12.28%, yen 7.59% and sterling 7.44%; the next review is scheduled for 2027.
- **Analytical inference:** A diversified basket reduces dependence on one currency for the unit of account.
- **Qualification:** Weights are not the same as the fixed currency amounts used in daily valuation, and the dollar value changes daily.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not freeze one day's SDR-dollar rate as a permanent conversion.

MAINS USE

Date the basket and distinguish weights from currency amounts.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The SDR's daily value is calculated from fixed currency amounts derived from reviewed basket weights and market exchange rates.
- Evidence anchor: Weights effective 1 August 2022 are US dollar 43.38%, euro 29.31%, renminbi 12.28%, yen 7.59% and sterling 7.44%; the next review is scheduled for 2027.
- Verdict: SDR valuation basket matters because a diversified basket reduces dependence on one currency for the unit of account.

CORE SESSION 29 - IMF crisis finance in the global safety net

VISUAL FIRST

IMF CRISIS FINANCE IN THE GLOBAL SAFETY NET

shock -> reserves/market response -> regional or swap support -> IMF programme

BOUNDARY -> Access remains uneven, and solvency problems require restructuring rather than liquidity alone.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IMF lending is the near-universal pooled layer of the global financial safety net when reserves and market access are insufficient.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IMF crisis finance in the global safety net matters because pooling can be more efficient than universal self-insurance through costly reserve accumulation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: global financial safety net, liquidity, solvency, pooling, access

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IMF crisis finance in the global safety net matters because pooling can be more efficient than universal self-insurance through costly reserve accumulation.
- **Named evidence:** The IMF's 2025 safety-net stocktaking identifies reserves, bilateral swaps, regional financing arrangements and the Fund as complementary layers.
- **Analysis:** Pooling can be more efficient than universal self-insurance through costly reserve accumulation.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Access remains uneven, and solvency problems require restructuring rather than liquidity alone.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The IMF's 2025 safety-net stocktaking identifies reserves, bilateral swaps, regional financing arrangements and the Fund as complementary layers.
- **Analytical inference:** Pooling can be more efficient than universal self-insurance through costly reserve accumulation.
- **Qualification:** Access remains uneven, and solvency problems require restructuring rather than liquidity alone.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not use a liquidity facility to conceal unsustainable debt.

MAINS USE

Diagnose liquidity, solvency and adjustment before prescribing the layer.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IMF lending is the near-universal pooled layer of the global financial safety net when reserves and market access are insufficient.
- Evidence anchor: The IMF's 2025 safety-net stocktaking identifies reserves, bilateral swaps, regional financing arrangements and the Fund as complementary layers.
- Verdict: IMF crisis finance in the global safety net matters because pooling can be more efficient than universal self-insurance through costly reserve accumulation.

CORE SESSION 30 - India and the 1991 IMF episode

VISUAL FIRST

INDIA AND THE 1991 IMF EPISODE

reserve stress -> external assistance -> stabilisation -> structural reform -> recovery

BOUNDARY -> Not every 1991 reform was mechanically dictated by one IMF condition, and India has no current IMF programme.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

India's 1991 IMF engagement was part of a severe balance-of-payments adjustment alongside domestic structural reforms.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: India and the 1991 IMF episode matters because the episode shows how crisis finance can support adjustment while domestic political choices determine reform design.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: 1991 crisis, stabilisation, structural reform, policy ownership, historical case

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** India and the 1991 IMF episode matters because the episode shows how crisis finance can support adjustment while domestic political choices determine reform design.
- **Named evidence:** Ramesh Singh's historical account and the canonical owner use 1991 to distinguish IMF stabilisation from development-project finance.
- **Analysis:** The episode shows how crisis finance can support adjustment while domestic political choices determine reform design.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Not every 1991 reform was mechanically dictated by one IMF condition, and India has no current IMF programme.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Ramesh Singh's historical account and the canonical owner use 1991 to distinguish IMF stabilisation from development-project finance.
- **Analytical inference:** The episode shows how crisis finance can support adjustment while domestic political choices determine reform design.
- **Qualification:** Not every 1991 reform was mechanically dictated by one IMF condition, and India has no current IMF programme.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not project 1991 conditionality onto routine Article IV surveillance today.

MAINS USE

Use 1991 as a bounded historical example, not a universal template.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: India's 1991 IMF engagement was part of a severe balance-of-payments adjustment alongside domestic structural reforms.
- Evidence anchor: Ramesh Singh's historical account and the canonical owner use 1991 to distinguish IMF stabilisation from development-project finance.
- Verdict: India and the 1991 IMF episode matters because the episode shows how crisis finance can support adjustment while domestic political choices determine reform design.

CORE SESSION 31 - IMF governance reform debate

VISUAL FIRST

IMF GOVERNANCE REFORM DEBATE

economic weights change -> representation gap -> reform bargain -> ratification

BOUNDARY -> A larger quota envelope is not the same as voice reform.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IMF reform concerns quota realignment, basic votes, board representation, resource adequacy, leadership selection and programme legitimacy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IMF governance reform debate matters because more representative governance can improve legitimacy, but resource contributions and creditor confidence remain relevant.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: quota realignment, basic votes, legitimacy, leadership selection, resources

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IMF governance reform debate matters because more representative governance can improve legitimacy, but resource contributions and creditor confidence remain relevant.
- **Named evidence:** The 16th Review raises total quotas equiproportionally while leaving relative shares unchanged.
- **Analysis:** More representative governance can improve legitimacy, but resource contributions and creditor confidence remain relevant.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A larger quota envelope is not the same as voice reform.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The 16th Review raises total quotas equiproportionally while leaving relative shares unchanged.
- **Analytical inference:** More representative governance can improve legitimacy, but resource contributions and creditor confidence remain relevant.
- **Qualification:** A larger quota envelope is not the same as voice reform.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not equate institutional reform with simply increasing total lending.

MAINS USE

Frame reform around voice, capacity, accountability and effectiveness.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IMF reform concerns quota realignment, basic votes, board representation, resource adequacy, leadership selection and programme legitimacy.
- Evidence anchor: The 16th Review raises total quotas equiproportionally while leaving relative shares unchanged.
- Verdict: IMF governance reform debate matters because more representative governance can improve legitimacy, but resource contributions and creditor confidence remain relevant.

CORE SESSION 32 - World Bank versus World Bank Group

VISUAL FIRST

WORLD BANK VERSUS WORLD BANK GROUP

World Bank = IBRD + IDA | Group = plus IFC + MIGA + ICSID

BOUNDARY -> Coordination under one group does not erase separate Articles, membership and balance sheets.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

World Bank commonly means IBRD and IDA; World Bank Group additionally includes IFC, MIGA and ICSID.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: World Bank versus World Bank Group matters because the distinction prevents sovereign lending from being confused with private finance, guarantees or arbitration facilities.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: World Bank, World Bank Group, IBRD, IDA, IFC, MIGA, ICSID

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** World Bank versus World Bank Group matters because the distinction prevents sovereign lending from being confused with private finance, guarantees or arbitration facilities.
- **Named evidence:** Official World Bank pages identify five legally distinct institutions with related development purposes.
- **Analysis:** The distinction prevents sovereign lending from being confused with private finance, guarantees or arbitration facilities.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Coordination under one group does not erase separate Articles, membership and balance sheets.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Official World Bank pages identify five legally distinct institutions with related development purposes.
- **Analytical inference:** The distinction prevents sovereign lending from being confused with private finance, guarantees or arbitration facilities.
- **Qualification:** Coordination under one group does not erase separate Articles, membership and balance sheets.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not list IFC as an IMF arm or call ICSID a lender.

MAINS USE

Start any World Bank answer with the two-versus-five distinction.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: World Bank commonly means IBRD and IDA; World Bank Group additionally includes IFC, MIGA and ICSID.
- Evidence anchor: Official World Bank pages identify five legally distinct institutions with related development purposes.
- Verdict: World Bank versus World Bank Group matters because the distinction prevents sovereign lending from being confused with private finance, guarantees or arbitration facilities.

CORE SESSION 33 - IBRD mandate

VISUAL FIRST

IBRD MANDATE

shareholder capital -> bond borrowing -> sovereign loan/guarantee -> repayment

BOUNDARY -> IBRD is not the only institution working to reduce poverty and does not target only the poorest countries.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IBRD lends to creditworthy middle-income and eligible lower-income sovereign borrowers and raises most lending funds in capital markets.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IBRD mandate matters because its market-based funding and preferred-creditor standing support long maturities at terms linked to funding and risk.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: IBRD, creditworthy sovereign, bonds, loans, guarantees, reconstruction

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IBRD mandate matters because its market-based funding and preferred-creditor standing support long maturities at terms linked to funding and risk.
- **Named evidence:** The 2025 UPSC question correctly links IBRD to post-war reconstruction and loans or guarantees for middle-income countries.
- **Analysis:** Its market-based funding and preferred-creditor standing support long maturities at terms linked to funding and risk.
- **Qualification / demand link:** IBRD is not the only institution working to reduce poverty and does not target only the poorest countries.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The 2025 UPSC question correctly links IBRD to post-war reconstruction and loans or guarantees for middle-income countries.
- **Analytical inference:** Its market-based funding and preferred-creditor standing support long maturities at terms linked to funding and risk.
- **Qualification:** IBRD is not the only institution working to reduce poverty and does not target only the poorest countries.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not merge IBRD with IDA's concessional window.

MAINS USE

Connect creditworthiness, market borrowing and sovereign development finance.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IBRD lends to creditworthy middle-income and eligible lower-income sovereign borrowers and raises most lending funds in capital markets.
- Evidence anchor: The 2025 UPSC question correctly links IBRD to post-war reconstruction and loans or guarantees for middle-income countries.
- Verdict: IBRD mandate matters because its market-based funding and preferred-creditor standing support long maturities at terms linked to funding and risk.

CORE SESSION 34 - IDA mandate and eligibility

VISUAL FIRST

IDA MANDATE AND ELIGIBILITY

donor replenishment + repayments -> concessional credit/grant -> development

BOUNDARY -> The cutoff and eligible list are updated; blend countries can access both IDA and IBRD.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IDA provides concessional credits and grants to eligible poorer countries, with eligibility based mainly on income and creditworthiness.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IDA mandate and eligibility matters because concessionality expands fiscal space for high-development-return investments where market borrowing is costly.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: IDA, concessional credit, grant, FY2027, USD 1,365, blend country

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IDA mandate and eligibility matters because concessionality expands fiscal space for high-development-return investments where market borrowing is costly.
- **Named evidence:** The official IDA page states that 78 countries are eligible in FY2027 and uses a GNI-per-capita operational cutoff of USD 1,365, with exceptions including some small economies.
- **Analysis:** Concessionality expands fiscal space for high-development-return investments where market borrowing is costly.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The cutoff and eligible list are updated; blend countries can access both IDA and IBRD.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The official IDA page states that 78 countries are eligible in FY2027 and uses a GNI-per-capita operational cutoff of USD 1,365, with exceptions including some small economies.
- **Analytical inference:** Concessionality expands fiscal space for high-development-return investments where market borrowing is costly.
- **Qualification:** The cutoff and eligible list are updated; blend countries can access both IDA and IBRD.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not say every low-income country receives grants or that all IDA members borrow.

MAINS USE

Date eligibility and distinguish members, donors, recipients and blend countries.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IDA provides concessional credits and grants to eligible poorer countries, with eligibility based mainly on income and creditworthiness.
- Evidence anchor: The official IDA page states that 78 countries are eligible in FY2027 and uses a GNI-per-capita operational cutoff of USD 1,365, with exceptions including some small economies.
- Verdict: IDA mandate and eligibility matters because concessionality expands fiscal space for high-development-return investments where market borrowing is costly.

CORE SESSION 35 - IFC mandate

VISUAL FIRST

IFC MANDATE

private project -> IFC appraisal -> debt/equity/mobilisation -> development impact

BOUNDARY -> Commercial discipline and development additionality must both be tested; IFC is not a grant agency.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IFC finances and mobilises private investment in developing countries through loans, equity, guarantees and advisory work without sovereign guarantees as its ordinary model.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IFC mandate matters because iFC can absorb risk, demonstrate viability and mobilise capital where markets underprovide.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: IFC, private sector, equity, loan, mobilisation, additionality

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IFC mandate matters because iFC can absorb risk, demonstrate viability and mobilise capital where markets underprovide.
- **Named evidence:** IFC's official governance page states that it is owned by 186 members and uses share-capital-weighted voting.
- **Analysis:** IFC can absorb risk, demonstrate viability and mobilise capital where markets underprovide.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Commercial discipline and development additionality must both be tested; IFC is not a grant agency.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IFC's official governance page states that it is owned by 186 members and uses share-capital-weighted voting.
- **Analytical inference:** IFC can absorb risk, demonstrate viability and mobilise capital where markets underprovide.
- **Qualification:** Commercial discipline and development additionality must both be tested; IFC is not a grant agency.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call IFC a sovereign concessional lender.

MAINS USE

Use client type and instrument to distinguish IFC from IBRD and IDA.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IFC finances and mobilises private investment in developing countries through loans, equity, guarantees and advisory work without sovereign guarantees as its ordinary model.
- Evidence anchor: IFC's official governance page states that it is owned by 186 members and uses share-capital-weighted voting.
- Verdict: IFC mandate matters because iFC can absorb risk, demonstrate viability and mobilise capital where markets underprovide.

CORE SESSION 36 - MIGA mandate

VISUAL FIRST

MIGA MANDATE

eligible investment -> guarantee -> risk reduction -> private capital mobilisation

BOUNDARY -> A guarantee covers defined risks and terms; it does not eliminate commercial failure or all sovereign risk.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

MIGA promotes cross-border investment through political-risk insurance and credit enhancement rather than ordinary project lending.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: MIGA mandate matters because risk transfer can make projects financeable by protecting against specified non-commercial risks.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: MIGA, political-risk insurance, credit enhancement, expropriation, mobilisation

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** MIGA mandate matters because risk transfer can make projects financeable by protecting against specified non-commercial risks.
- **Named evidence:** MIGA's current member page lists 182 members: 154 developing and 28 industrialised countries.
- **Analysis:** Risk transfer can make projects financeable by protecting against specified non-commercial risks.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A guarantee covers defined risks and terms; it does not eliminate commercial failure or all sovereign risk.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** MIGA's current member page lists 182 members: 154 developing and 28 industrialised countries.
- **Analytical inference:** Risk transfer can make projects financeable by protecting against specified non-commercial risks.
- **Qualification:** A guarantee covers defined risks and terms; it does not eliminate commercial failure or all sovereign risk.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not describe MIGA as paying grants to governments.

MAINS USE

Explain risk covered, beneficiary and mobilisation channel.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: MIGA promotes cross-border investment through political-risk insurance and credit enhancement rather than ordinary project lending.
- Evidence anchor: MIGA's current member page lists 182 members: 154 developing and 28 industrialised countries.
- Verdict: MIGA mandate matters because risk transfer can make projects financeable by protecting against specified non-commercial risks.

CORE SESSION 37 - ICSID mandate and India's status

VISUAL FIRST

ICSID MANDATE AND INDIA'S STATUS

consent -> registration -> tribunal -> award -> recognition/enforcement

BOUNDARY -> Jurisdiction depends on consent and the applicable treaty or contract; ICSID does not finance projects.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

ICSID administers conciliation and arbitration of qualifying investment disputes between states and foreign investors under consent-based legal instruments.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: ICSID mandate and India's status matters because a specialised forum can depoliticise disputes and support investment confidence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: ICSID, arbitration, consent, Contracting State, India non-member

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** ICSID mandate and India's status matters because a specialised forum can depoliticise disputes and support investment confidence.
- **Named evidence:** Official ICSID lists dated August 2026 record 166 signatories and 158 Contracting States; India is neither a signatory nor a Contracting State.
- **Analysis:** A specialised forum can depoliticise disputes and support investment confidence.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Jurisdiction depends on consent and the applicable treaty or contract; ICSID does not finance projects.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Official ICSID lists dated August 2026 record 166 signatories and 158 Contracting States; India is neither a signatory nor a Contracting State.
- **Analytical inference:** A specialised forum can depoliticise disputes and support investment confidence.
- **Qualification:** Jurisdiction depends on consent and the applicable treaty or contract; ICSID does not finance projects.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not list India as an ICSID Convention member merely because it belongs to the World Bank.

MAINS USE

Separate institutional affiliation, treaty membership, jurisdiction and award enforcement.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: ICSID administers conciliation and arbitration of qualifying investment disputes between states and foreign investors under consent-based legal instruments.
- Evidence anchor: Official ICSID lists dated August 2026 record 166 signatories and 158 Contracting States; India is neither a signatory nor a Contracting State.
- Verdict: ICSID mandate and India's status matters because a specialised forum can depoliticise disputes and support investment confidence.

CORE SESSION 38 - World Bank Group membership and governance

VISUAL FIRST

WORLD BANK GROUP MEMBERSHIP AND GOVERNANCE

membership -> subscription -> governors -> executive directors -> operations

BOUNDARY -> ICSID membership is separate, and member counts differ across the five institutions.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

World Bank Group institutions are owned by member governments but have institution-specific membership and weighted voting arrangements.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: World Bank Group membership and governance matters because weighted governance connects financial stake to voice while boards enable continuous oversight.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: member government, Board of Governors, Executive Directors, weighted voting

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** World Bank Group membership and governance matters because weighted governance connects financial stake to voice while boards enable continuous oversight.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank governance material checked at the cutoff lists 189 IBRD members, 182 MIGA members and 25 resident Executive Directors; IDA, IFC and MIGA membership requires prior IBRD membership.
- **Analysis:** Weighted governance connects financial stake to voice while boards enable continuous oversight.
- **Qualification / demand link:** ICSID membership is separate, and member counts differ across the five institutions.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank governance material checked at the cutoff lists 189 IBRD members, 182 MIGA members and 25 resident Executive Directors; IDA, IFC and MIGA membership requires prior IBRD membership.
- **Analytical inference:** Weighted governance connects financial stake to voice while boards enable continuous oversight.
- **Qualification:** ICSID membership is separate, and member counts differ across the five institutions.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not apply one institution's vote share or membership list to all five.

MAINS USE

Date the institution-specific count and identify its governing board.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: World Bank Group institutions are owned by member governments but have institution-specific membership and weighted voting arrangements.
- Evidence anchor: World Bank governance material checked at the cutoff lists 189 IBRD members, 182 MIGA members and 25 resident Executive Directors; IDA, IFC and MIGA membership requires prior IBRD membership.
- Verdict: World Bank Group membership and governance matters because weighted governance connects financial stake to voice while boards enable continuous oversight.

CORE SESSION 39 - World Bank leadership

VISUAL FIRST

WORLD BANK LEADERSHIP

Executive Directors select -> President leads -> Boards approve

BOUNDARY -> The officeholder and term are current facts and require a dated source.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The World Bank Group President chairs the IBRD and IDA Executive Boards and leads Group strategy, subject to member governance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: World Bank leadership matters because leadership matters for operational priorities but cannot replace Board approvals or member Articles.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Ajay Banga, 2 June 2023, five-year term, Board, leadership

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** World Bank leadership matters because leadership matters for operational priorities but cannot replace Board approvals or member Articles.
- **Named evidence:** Ajay Banga began a five-year term as the 14th World Bank President on 2 June 2023.
- **Analysis:** Leadership matters for operational priorities but cannot replace Board approvals or member Articles.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The officeholder and term are current facts and require a dated source.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Ajay Banga began a five-year term as the 14th World Bank President on 2 June 2023.
- **Analytical inference:** Leadership matters for operational priorities but cannot replace Board approvals or member Articles.
- **Qualification:** The officeholder and term are current facts and require a dated source.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not attribute every institutional decision personally to the President.

MAINS USE

Use leadership only after explaining formal governance.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The World Bank Group President chairs the IBRD and IDA Executive Boards and leads Group strategy, subject to member governance.
- Evidence anchor: Ajay Banga began a five-year term as the 14th World Bank President on 2 June 2023.
- Verdict: World Bank leadership matters because leadership matters for operational priorities but cannot replace Board approvals or member Articles.

CORE SESSION 40 - IBRD financing model

VISUAL FIRST

IBRD FINANCING MODEL

capital strength -> AAA borrowing -> long-term finance -> repayment -> recycled capacity
BOUNDARY -> Callable capital is a backstop, not routine cash available for immediate spending.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IBRD combines paid-in and callable shareholder capital, retained earnings and market borrowing to fund sovereign loans and guarantees.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IBRD financing model matters because leverage expands development lending beyond paid-in capital while risk controls preserve borrowing costs.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: paid-in capital, callable capital, bonds, AAA, lending capacity

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IBRD financing model matters because leverage expands development lending beyond paid-in capital while risk controls preserve borrowing costs.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank financial material identifies bond issuance as a central IBRD funding source.
- **Analysis:** Leverage expands development lending beyond paid-in capital while risk controls preserve borrowing costs.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Callable capital is a backstop, not routine cash available for immediate spending.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank financial material identifies bond issuance as a central IBRD funding source.
- **Analytical inference:** Leverage expands development lending beyond paid-in capital while risk controls preserve borrowing costs.
- **Qualification:** Callable capital is a backstop, not routine cash available for immediate spending.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not equate authorised capital with annual lending.

MAINS USE

Distinguish subscribed, paid-in, callable, borrowed and disbursed amounts.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IBRD combines paid-in and callable shareholder capital, retained earnings and market borrowing to fund sovereign loans and guarantees.
- Evidence anchor: World Bank financial material identifies bond issuance as a central IBRD funding source.
- Verdict: IBRD financing model matters because leverage expands development lending beyond paid-in capital while risk controls preserve borrowing costs.

CORE SESSION 41 - IDA replenishment model

VISUAL FIRST

IDA REPLENISHMENT MODEL

donor negotiation -> replenishment envelope -> country allocation -> credit/grant

BOUNDARY -> Pledges, commitments and disbursements are different stages, and grant allocation depends on debt risk and policy rules.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

IDA resources are periodically replenished by donor contributions, internal transfers, repayments and market funding to support concessional finance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IDA replenishment model matters because replenishment converts collective contributions into predictable development capacity.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: replenishment, concessionality, donor, allocation, grant, credit

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IDA replenishment model matters because replenishment converts collective contributions into predictable development capacity.
- **Named evidence:** IDA financing pages describe multi-year replenishments and concessional terms for eligible borrowers.
- **Analysis:** Replenishment converts collective contributions into predictable development capacity.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Pledges, commitments and disbursements are different stages, and grant allocation depends on debt risk and policy rules.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IDA financing pages describe multi-year replenishments and concessional terms for eligible borrowers.
- **Analytical inference:** Replenishment converts collective contributions into predictable development capacity.
- **Qualification:** Pledges, commitments and disbursements are different stages, and grant allocation depends on debt risk and policy rules.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not report a replenishment headline as money already disbursed to one country.

MAINS USE

Use stage, eligibility and financing terms in any IDA statistic.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: IDA resources are periodically replenished by donor contributions, internal transfers, repayments and market funding to support concessional finance.
- Evidence anchor: IDA financing pages describe multi-year replenishments and concessional terms for eligible borrowers.
- Verdict: IDA replenishment model matters because replenishment converts collective contributions into predictable development capacity.

CORE SESSION 42 - Country Partnership Framework

VISUAL FIRST

COUNTRY PARTNERSHIP FRAMEWORK

diagnostic -> country priorities -> CPF objectives -> operations -> learning review

BOUNDARY -> The framework guides programming but does not guarantee finance or substitute for project approval.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

A Country Partnership Framework aligns World Bank Group engagement with a country's development priorities and the Group's comparative advantage.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Country Partnership Framework matters because a common framework can coordinate IBRD, IDA, IFC and MIGA instruments around outcomes.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: CPF, diagnostic, selectivity, country ownership, outcomes

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Country Partnership Framework matters because a common framework can coordinate IBRD, IDA, IFC and MIGA instruments around outcomes.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank guidance uses country diagnostics and partnership frameworks to organise multi-year engagement.
- **Analysis:** A common framework can coordinate IBRD, IDA, IFC and MIGA instruments around outcomes.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The framework guides programming but does not guarantee finance or substitute for project approval.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank guidance uses country diagnostics and partnership frameworks to organise multi-year engagement.
- **Analytical inference:** A common framework can coordinate IBRD, IDA, IFC and MIGA instruments around outcomes.
- **Qualification:** The framework guides programming but does not guarantee finance or substitute for project approval.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not treat a strategy document as a sovereign loan agreement.

MAINS USE

Link country ownership, selectivity and measurable outcomes.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: A Country Partnership Framework aligns World Bank Group engagement with a country's development priorities and the Group's comparative advantage.
- Evidence anchor: World Bank guidance uses country diagnostics and partnership frameworks to organise multi-year engagement.
- Verdict: Country Partnership Framework matters because a common framework can coordinate IBRD, IDA, IFC and MIGA instruments around outcomes.

CORE SESSION 43 - MDB project cycle

VISUAL FIRST

MDB PROJECT CYCLE

identify -> prepare -> appraise -> negotiate/approve -> implement -> evaluate

BOUNDARY -> Stages overlap and differ by instrument; Board approval is not disbursement or successful completion.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The project cycle moves from identification and preparation through appraisal, negotiation, approval, implementation, completion and evaluation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: MDB project cycle matters because sequencing tests technical, economic, financial, environmental and implementation readiness before resources are committed.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: identification, preparation, appraisal, approval, implementation, evaluation

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** MDB project cycle matters because sequencing tests technical, economic, financial, environmental and implementation readiness before resources are committed.
- **Named evidence:** The World Bank project-cycle guidance assigns preparation mainly to the borrower and appraisal and approval roles to Bank teams and the Board.
- **Analysis:** Sequencing tests technical, economic, financial, environmental and implementation readiness before resources are committed.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Stages overlap and differ by instrument; Board approval is not disbursement or successful completion.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The World Bank project-cycle guidance assigns preparation mainly to the borrower and appraisal and approval roles to Bank teams and the Board.
- **Analytical inference:** Sequencing tests technical, economic, financial, environmental and implementation readiness before resources are committed.
- **Qualification:** Stages overlap and differ by instrument; Board approval is not disbursement or successful completion.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call a proposed or approved project completed.

MAINS USE

Use the lifecycle to diagnose delay, redesign and accountability.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The project cycle moves from identification and preparation through appraisal, negotiation, approval, implementation, completion and evaluation.
- Evidence anchor: The World Bank project-cycle guidance assigns preparation mainly to the borrower and appraisal and approval roles to Bank teams and the Board.
- Verdict: MDB project cycle matters because sequencing tests technical, economic, financial, environmental and implementation readiness before resources are committed.

CORE SESSION 44 - IPF, DPF and Program-for-Results

VISUAL FIRST

IPF, DPF AND PROGRAM-FOR-RESULTS

physical investment | policy action | verified programme result

BOUNDARY -> A DPF operation is not an IMF programme, and PforR is not reimbursement for any expenditure.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Investment Project Financing funds defined activities, Development Policy Financing supports policy and institutional actions, and Program-for-Results links disbursement to verified results using country systems.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: IPF, DPF and Program-for-Results matters because instrument choice changes fiduciary controls, timing and the transmission from finance to outcomes.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: IPF, DPF, PforR, disbursement-linked result, policy action

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** IPF, DPF and Program-for-Results matters because instrument choice changes fiduciary controls, timing and the transmission from finance to outcomes.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank operational categories distinguish IPF, DPF and PforR by object and disbursement logic.
- **Analysis:** Instrument choice changes fiduciary controls, timing and the transmission from finance to outcomes.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A DPF operation is not an IMF programme, and PforR is not reimbursement for any expenditure.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank operational categories distinguish IPF, DPF and PforR by object and disbursement logic.
- **Analytical inference:** Instrument choice changes fiduciary controls, timing and the transmission from finance to outcomes.
- **Qualification:** A DPF operation is not an IMF programme, and PforR is not reimbursement for any expenditure.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not infer a project asset from every World Bank loan.

MAINS USE

Name the financing instrument before evaluating conditions.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Investment Project Financing funds defined activities, Development Policy Financing supports policy and institutional actions, and Program-for-Results links disbursement to verified results using country systems.
- Evidence anchor: World Bank operational categories distinguish IPF, DPF and PforR by object and disbursement logic.
- Verdict: IPF, DPF and Program-for-Results matters because instrument choice changes fiduciary controls, timing and the transmission from finance to outcomes.

CORE SESSION 45 - Environmental and social safeguards

VISUAL FIRST

ENVIRONMENTAL AND SOCIAL SAFEGUARDS

risk screening -> assessment -> mitigation plan -> consultation -> monitoring/remedy

BOUNDARY -> Compliance can raise preparation time and cost, but weak safeguards can shift losses to communities and ecosystems.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

MDB safeguards are rules and processes for identifying, avoiding, mitigating and remedying environmental and social harm.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Environmental and social safeguards matters because safeguards internalise project externalities and improve legitimacy and durability.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: ESF, ESS, consultation, mitigation hierarchy, grievance, externality

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Environmental and social safeguards matters because safeguards internalise project externalities and improve legitimacy and durability.
- **Named evidence:** The World Bank Environmental and Social Framework has applied to new investment projects since 2018 through ten Environmental and Social Standards.
- **Analysis:** Safeguards internalise project externalities and improve legitimacy and durability.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Compliance can raise preparation time and cost, but weak safeguards can shift losses to communities and ecosystems.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The World Bank Environmental and Social Framework has applied to new investment projects since 2018 through ten Environmental and Social Standards.
- **Analytical inference:** Safeguards internalise project externalities and improve legitimacy and durability.
- **Qualification:** Compliance can raise preparation time and cost, but weak safeguards can shift losses to communities and ecosystems.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not describe safeguards as optional charity.

MAINS USE

Balance speed with risk proportionality, participation and remedy.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: MDB safeguards are rules and processes for identifying, avoiding, mitigating and remedying environmental and social harm.
- Evidence anchor: The World Bank Environmental and Social Framework has applied to new investment projects since 2018 through ten Environmental and Social Standards.
- Verdict: Environmental and social safeguards matters because safeguards internalise project externalities and improve legitimacy and durability.

CORE SESSION 46 - MDB procurement

VISUAL FIRST

MDB PROCUREMENT

needs plan -> procurement strategy -> competition -> contract -> oversight

BOUNDARY -> Lowest bid alone may not provide best value, and domestic procurement law still interacts with loan requirements.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

MDB procurement frameworks govern how financed contracts are planned, competed, awarded and monitored to achieve value for money and integrity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: MDB procurement matters because transparent procurement can reduce corruption and lifecycle cost while allowing project-specific methods.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: procurement framework, value for money, competition, integrity, complaint

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** MDB procurement matters because transparent procurement can reduce corruption and lifecycle cost while allowing project-specific methods.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank procurement guidance emphasises value for money, fit-for-purpose design, economy, integrity and sustainable procurement.
- **Analysis:** Transparent procurement can reduce corruption and lifecycle cost while allowing project-specific methods.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Lowest bid alone may not provide best value, and domestic procurement law still interacts with loan requirements.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank procurement guidance emphasises value for money, fit-for-purpose design, economy, integrity and sustainable procurement.
- **Analytical inference:** Transparent procurement can reduce corruption and lifecycle cost while allowing project-specific methods.
- **Qualification:** Lowest bid alone may not provide best value, and domestic procurement law still interacts with loan requirements.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not equate international competitive procurement with automatic foreign award.

MAINS USE

Assess competition, capability, lifecycle value and complaints.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: MDB procurement frameworks govern how financed contracts are planned, competed, awarded and monitored to achieve value for money and integrity.
- Evidence anchor: World Bank procurement guidance emphasises value for money, fit-for-purpose design, economy, integrity and sustainable procurement.
- Verdict: MDB procurement matters because transparent procurement can reduce corruption and lifecycle cost while allowing project-specific methods.

CORE SESSION 47 - MDB accountability mechanisms

VISUAL FIRST

MDB ACCOUNTABILITY MECHANISMS

harm allegation -> eligibility -> compliance/problem solving -> action plan -> monitoring

BOUNDARY -> Mechanisms do not replace national courts, compensation law or every project grievance channel.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Independent accountability mechanisms allow project-affected people to raise compliance or problem-solving claims outside normal management channels.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: MDB accountability mechanisms matters because independent review can reveal whether safeguard commitments translated into implementation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: accountability mechanism, compliance review, problem solving, remedy, affected people

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** MDB accountability mechanisms matters because independent review can reveal whether safeguard commitments translated into implementation.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank, ADB and AIIB each maintain institution-specific accountability or project-affected-people mechanisms.
- **Analysis:** Independent review can reveal whether safeguard commitments translated into implementation.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Mechanisms do not replace national courts, compensation law or every project grievance channel.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank, ADB and AIIB each maintain institution-specific accountability or project-affected-people mechanisms.
- **Analytical inference:** Independent review can reveal whether safeguard commitments translated into implementation.
- **Qualification:** Mechanisms do not replace national courts, compensation law or every project grievance channel.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not claim a complaint automatically cancels a project.

MAINS USE

Use remedy access as a governance-quality indicator.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Independent accountability mechanisms allow project-affected people to raise compliance or problem-solving claims outside normal management channels.
- Evidence anchor: World Bank, ADB and AIIB each maintain institution-specific accountability or project-affected-people mechanisms.
- Verdict: MDB accountability mechanisms matters because independent review can reveal whether safeguard commitments translated into implementation.

CORE SESSION 48 - Debt sustainability in development lending

VISUAL FIRST

DEBT SUSTAINABILITY IN DEVELOPMENT LENDING

debt stock + terms + growth + revenue + shocks -> DSA -> financing terms

BOUNDARY -> A risk rating is a forward-looking assessment, not certainty; domestic debt and contingent liabilities also matter.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Debt sustainability asks whether a borrower can service obligations under plausible shocks without unrealistic adjustment or arrears.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Debt sustainability in development lending matters because concessional finance can improve affordability, but a weak project or large foreign-currency exposure can still increase distress.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: DSA, debt service, concessionality, stress test, currency risk

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Debt sustainability in development lending matters because concessional finance can improve affordability, but a weak project or large foreign-currency exposure can still increase distress.
- **Named evidence:** The joint IMF-World Bank Debt Sustainability Framework uses baseline and stress scenarios for low-income countries.
- **Analysis:** Concessional finance can improve affordability, but a weak project or large foreign-currency exposure can still increase distress.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A risk rating is a forward-looking assessment, not certainty; domestic debt and contingent liabilities also matter.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The joint IMF-World Bank Debt Sustainability Framework uses baseline and stress scenarios for low-income countries.
- **Analytical inference:** Concessional finance can improve affordability, but a weak project or large foreign-currency exposure can still increase distress.
- **Qualification:** A risk rating is a forward-looking assessment, not certainty; domestic debt and contingent liabilities also matter.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not infer sustainability from a low interest rate alone.

MAINS USE

Connect project returns, currency, maturity and fiscal capacity.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** Debt sustainability asks whether a borrower can service obligations under plausible shocks without unrealistic adjustment or arrears.
- **Evidence anchor:** The joint IMF-World Bank Debt Sustainability Framework uses baseline and stress scenarios for low-income countries.
- **Verdict:** Debt sustainability in development lending matters because concessional finance can improve affordability, but a weak project or large foreign-currency exposure can still increase distress.

CORE SESSION 49 - MDB additionality and co-financing

VISUAL FIRST

MDB ADDITIONALITY AND CO-FINANCING

market gap -> MDB finance/guarantee -> private co-finance -> development result

BOUNDARY -> Mobilisation must be measured against a counterfactual; public support can also displace private finance.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Additionality means an MDB provides finance, risk absorption, standards or knowledge that would not otherwise be available on comparable terms.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: MDB additionality and co-financing matters because risk sharing can crowd in investors and scale projects beyond the MDB's own balance sheet.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: additionality, mobilisation, co-financing, guarantee, counterfactual

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** MDB additionality and co-financing matters because risk sharing can crowd in investors and scale projects beyond the MDB's own balance sheet.
- **Named evidence:** MDB strategies use guarantees, syndication and co-financing to mobilise public and private resources.
- **Analysis:** Risk sharing can crowd in investors and scale projects beyond the MDB's own balance sheet.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Mobilisation must be measured against a counterfactual; public support can also displace private finance.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** MDB strategies use guarantees, syndication and co-financing to mobilise public and private resources.
- **Analytical inference:** Risk sharing can crowd in investors and scale projects beyond the MDB's own balance sheet.
- **Qualification:** Mobilisation must be measured against a counterfactual; public support can also displace private finance.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not count all project finance as mobilised solely by the MDB.

MAINS USE

Use a counterfactual, risk-transfer and development-impact test.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Additionality means an MDB provides finance, risk absorption, standards or knowledge that would not otherwise be available on comparable terms.
- Evidence anchor: MDB strategies use guarantees, syndication and co-financing to mobilise public and private resources.
- Verdict: MDB additionality and co-financing matters because risk sharing can crowd in investors and scale projects beyond the MDB's own balance sheet.

CORE SESSION 50 - Asian Development Bank origin and mandate

VISUAL FIRST

ASIAN DEVELOPMENT BANK ORIGIN AND MANDATE

regional membership -> capital -> sovereign/nonsovereign finance -> development

BOUNDARY -> Regional ownership does not mean every Asian economy has equal voting power or borrowing status.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

ADB is a regional multilateral development bank founded in 1966 to support sustainable, inclusive and resilient development in Asia and the Pacific.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Asian Development Bank origin and mandate matters because regional knowledge and long-term finance can address infrastructure, social and climate constraints.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: ADB, 1966, Manila, 69 members, 50 regional

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Asian Development Bank origin and mandate matters because regional knowledge and long-term finance can address infrastructure, social and climate constraints.
- **Named evidence:** ADB's current official page states that it has 69 members, 50 from the region, at the 9 September 2026 cutoff.
- **Analysis:** Regional knowledge and long-term finance can address infrastructure, social and climate constraints.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Regional ownership does not mean every Asian economy has equal voting power or borrowing status.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** ADB's current official page states that it has 69 members, 50 from the region, at the 9 September 2026 cutoff.
- **Analytical inference:** Regional knowledge and long-term finance can address infrastructure, social and climate constraints.
- **Qualification:** Regional ownership does not mean every Asian economy has equal voting power or borrowing status.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not confuse Manila-based ADB with Beijing-based AIIB.

MAINS USE

Compare ADB by region, age, capital and instruments.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: ADB is a regional multilateral development bank founded in 1966 to support sustainable, inclusive and resilient development in Asia and the Pacific.
- Evidence anchor: ADB's current official page states that it has 69 members, 50 from the region, at the 9 September 2026 cutoff.
- Verdict: Asian Development Bank origin and mandate matters because regional knowledge and long-term finance can address infrastructure, social and climate constraints.

CORE SESSION 51 - ADB governance and leadership

VISUAL FIRST

ADB GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP

shareholding -> governors/directors -> president -> operations

BOUNDARY -> The President manages under Board authority; nationality convention is not a treaty rule for all MDBs.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

ADB is governed by member shareholders through a Board of Governors and resident Board of Directors, with voting weighted by capital and basic votes.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: ADB governance and leadership matters because weighted governance supports creditor commitment but sustains representation debates.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Board of Governors, Board of Directors, weighted voting, Masato Kanda

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** ADB governance and leadership matters because weighted governance supports creditor commitment but sustains representation debates.
- **Named evidence:** Masato Kanda assumed office as ADB's 11th President on 24 February 2025.
- **Analysis:** Weighted governance supports creditor commitment but sustains representation debates.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The President manages under Board authority; nationality convention is not a treaty rule for all MDBs.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Masato Kanda assumed office as ADB's 11th President on 24 February 2025.
- **Analytical inference:** Weighted governance supports creditor commitment but sustains representation debates.
- **Qualification:** The President manages under Board authority; nationality convention is not a treaty rule for all MDBs.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not say ADB follows one-member-one-vote.

MAINS USE

Link leadership to formal board powers and shareholding.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: ADB is governed by member shareholders through a Board of Governors and resident Board of Directors, with voting weighted by capital and basic votes.
- Evidence anchor: Masato Kanda assumed office as ADB's 11th President on 24 February 2025.
- Verdict: ADB governance and leadership matters because weighted governance supports creditor commitment but sustains representation debates.

CORE SESSION 52 - India in ADB

VISUAL FIRST

INDIA IN ADB

capital share -> voting share -> country partnership -> approvals/disbursements

BOUNDARY -> Shareholding, voting power, cumulative commitments and current portfolio are different measures.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

India is an ADB founding member, shareholder and major borrower whose governance stake and project exposure must be separately measured.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: India in ADB matters because india's role combines influence over strategy with access to regional development finance.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: India, founding member, 6.317 percent shares, 5.343 percent votes

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** India in ADB matters because india's role combines influence over strategy with access to regional development finance.
- **Named evidence:** ADB's India page, valued at 31 December 2025, lists 672,030 shares or 6.317 percent and 710,577 votes or 5.343 percent of total membership.
- **Analysis:** India's role combines influence over strategy with access to regional development finance.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Shareholding, voting power, cumulative commitments and current portfolio are different measures.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** ADB's India page, valued at 31 December 2025, lists 672,030 shares or 6.317 percent and 710,577 votes or 5.343 percent of total membership.
- **Analytical inference:** India's role combines influence over strategy with access to regional development finance.
- **Qualification:** Shareholding, voting power, cumulative commitments and current portfolio are different measures.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call India the largest shareholder without checking the dated table.

MAINS USE

Use the exact dated share and vote only for governance analysis.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: India is an ADB founding member, shareholder and major borrower whose governance stake and project exposure must be separately measured.
- Evidence anchor: ADB's India page, valued at 31 December 2025, lists 672,030 shares or 6.317 percent and 710,577 votes or 5.343 percent of total membership.
- Verdict: India in ADB matters because india's role combines influence over strategy with access to regional development finance.

CORE SESSION 53 - ADB financing instruments

VISUAL FIRST

ADB FINANCING INSTRUMENTS

borrower/problem -> sovereign or private window -> instrument -> result

BOUNDARY -> Approval volume does not equal disbursement or development impact.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

ADB uses sovereign and nonsovereign loans, grants, guarantees, equity, technical assistance and co-financing according to country and project needs.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: ADB financing instruments matters because instrument diversity can match risk, revenue model and institutional capacity.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: sovereign, nonsovereign, guarantee, equity, technical assistance

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** ADB financing instruments matters because instrument diversity can match risk, revenue model and institutional capacity.
- **Named evidence:** ADB operational material describes public-sector and private-sector operations and technical assistance.
- **Analysis:** Instrument diversity can match risk, revenue model and institutional capacity.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Approval volume does not equal disbursement or development impact.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** ADB operational material describes public-sector and private-sector operations and technical assistance.
- **Analytical inference:** Instrument diversity can match risk, revenue model and institutional capacity.
- **Qualification:** Approval volume does not equal disbursement or development impact.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call every ADB operation a sovereign loan.

MAINS USE

Classify borrower, instrument, currency and implementation stage.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: ADB uses sovereign and nonsovereign loans, grants, guarantees, equity, technical assistance and co-financing according to country and project needs.
- Evidence anchor: ADB operational material describes public-sector and private-sector operations and technical assistance.
- Verdict: ADB financing instruments matters because instrument diversity can match risk, revenue model and institutional capacity.

CORE SESSION 54 - ADB Nature Solutions Finance Hub

VISUAL FIRST

ADB NATURE SOLUTIONS FINANCE HUB

COP28 launch -> upstream support + blended finance -> nature projects

BOUNDARY -> Targets are ambitions, not realised mobilisation; every project count requires a dated source.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The Nature Solutions Finance Hub for Asia and the Pacific is an ADB-led platform to catalyse finance for nature-based solutions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: ADB Nature Solutions Finance Hub matters because blended finance and guarantees can convert ecosystem benefits into investable programmes.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Nature Solutions Finance Hub, ADB, COP28, blended finance, target

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** ADB Nature Solutions Finance Hub matters because blended finance and guarantees can convert ecosystem benefits into investable programmes.
- **Named evidence:** ADB launched the Hub at COP28 in December 2023 with an initial ambition to catalyse at least USD 2 billion; later project material references an expanded USD 5 billion ambition.
- **Analysis:** Blended finance and guarantees can convert ecosystem benefits into investable programmes.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Targets are ambitions, not realised mobilisation; every project count requires a dated source.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** ADB launched the Hub at COP28 in December 2023 with an initial ambition to catalyse at least USD 2 billion; later project material references an expanded USD 5 billion ambition.
- **Analytical inference:** Blended finance and guarantees can convert ecosystem benefits into investable programmes.
- **Qualification:** Targets are ambitions, not realised mobilisation; every project count requires a dated source.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not attribute the Hub to AIIB, NDB, IBRD or the UN.

MAINS USE

Use the exact launcher and distinguish target from achieved finance.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The Nature Solutions Finance Hub for Asia and the Pacific is an ADB-led platform to catalyse finance for nature-based solutions.
- Evidence anchor: ADB launched the Hub at COP28 in December 2023 with an initial ambition to catalyse at least USD 2 billion; later project material references an expanded USD 5 billion ambition.
- Verdict: ADB Nature Solutions Finance Hub matters because blended finance and guarantees can convert ecosystem benefits into investable programmes.

CORE SESSION 55 - AIIB origin and mandate

VISUAL FIRST

AIIB ORIGIN AND MANDATE

2015 Articles -> 2016 operations -> infrastructure finance -> connectivity

BOUNDARY -> Approved membership is not the same as every prospective member completing domestic accession.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

AIIB is a multilateral development bank that began operations in 2016 and finances sustainable infrastructure and other productive sectors.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: AIIB origin and mandate matters because a newer MDB adds financing capacity and may innovate in partnership and project design.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: AIIB, 2016, Beijing, 111 approved members, USD 100 billion

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** AIIB origin and mandate matters because a newer MDB adds financing capacity and may innovate in partnership and project design.
- **Named evidence:** AIIB's 16 January 2026 release states that it has 111 approved members, authorised capital of USD 100 billion and an Infrastructure for Tomorrow mandate.
- **Analysis:** A newer MDB adds financing capacity and may innovate in partnership and project design.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Approved membership is not the same as every prospective member completing domestic accession.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** AIIB's 16 January 2026 release states that it has 111 approved members, authorised capital of USD 100 billion and an Infrastructure for Tomorrow mandate.
- **Analytical inference:** A newer MDB adds financing capacity and may innovate in partnership and project design.
- **Qualification:** Approved membership is not the same as every prospective member completing domestic accession.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call AIIB a bilateral Chinese policy bank.

MAINS USE

Compare its multilateral governance, infrastructure focus and co-financing.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: AIIB is a multilateral development bank that began operations in 2016 and finances sustainable infrastructure and other productive sectors.
- Evidence anchor: AIIB's 16 January 2026 release states that it has 111 approved members, authorised capital of USD 100 billion and an Infrastructure for Tomorrow mandate.
- Verdict: AIIB origin and mandate matters because a newer MDB adds financing capacity and may innovate in partnership and project design.

CORE SESSION 56 - AIIB governance and leadership

VISUAL FIRST

AIIB GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP

subscription + basic/founding votes -> total votes -> board governance

BOUNDARY -> The President does not possess a national veto and acts under the Board and Articles.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

AIIB uses weighted voting based on shares plus basic and founding-member votes under its Articles.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: AIIB governance and leadership matters because weighted voting creates large-shareholder influence while basic votes preserve a common member component.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: weighted voting, basic votes, founding votes, Zou Jiayi, Board

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** AIIB governance and leadership matters because weighted voting creates large-shareholder influence while basic votes preserve a common member component.
- **Named evidence:** Zou Jiayi assumed office as AIIB President and Board Chair on 16 January 2026 after election by the Board of Governors in June 2025.
- **Analysis:** Weighted voting creates large-shareholder influence while basic votes preserve a common member component.
- **Qualification / demand link:** The President does not possess a national veto and acts under the Board and Articles.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Zou Jiayi assumed office as AIIB President and Board Chair on 16 January 2026 after election by the Board of Governors in June 2025.
- **Analytical inference:** Weighted voting creates large-shareholder influence while basic votes preserve a common member component.
- **Qualification:** The President does not possess a national veto and acts under the Board and Articles.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not describe AIIB governance as one-country-one-vote.

MAINS USE

Separate capital share, voting share and management authority.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: AIIB uses weighted voting based on shares plus basic and founding-member votes under its Articles.
- Evidence anchor: Zou Jiayi assumed office as AIIB President and Board Chair on 16 January 2026 after election by the Board of Governors in June 2025.
- Verdict: AIIB governance and leadership matters because weighted voting creates large-shareholder influence while basic votes preserve a common member component.

CORE SESSION 57 - India in AIIB

VISUAL FIRST

INDIA IN AIIB

subscription -> voting power -> project pipeline -> development outcome

BOUNDARY -> Share and vote percentages differ because basic and founding votes affect total voting power.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

India is a founding regional member, the second-largest shareholder and a major borrower in AIIB.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: India in AIIB matters because a large stake gives India voice and access while preserving the need for project-level evaluation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: India, AIIB, USD 8,367.3 million, 8.5702 percent, 7.5268 percent

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** India in AIIB matters because a large stake gives India voice and access while preserving the need for project-level evaluation.
- **Named evidence:** AIIB's live voting table checked 9 September 2026 lists India's subscription at USD 8,367.3 million or 8.5702 percent and voting power at 7.5268 percent.
- **Analysis:** A large stake gives India voice and access while preserving the need for project-level evaluation.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Share and vote percentages differ because basic and founding votes affect total voting power.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** AIIB's live voting table checked 9 September 2026 lists India's subscription at USD 8,367.3 million or 8.5702 percent and voting power at 7.5268 percent.
- **Analytical inference:** A large stake gives India voice and access while preserving the need for project-level evaluation.
- **Qualification:** Share and vote percentages differ because basic and founding votes affect total voting power.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not quote India's capital share as its voting share.

MAINS USE

Use both dated percentages and explain the denominator.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: India is a founding regional member, the second-largest shareholder and a major borrower in AIIB.
- Evidence anchor: AIIB's live voting table checked 9 September 2026 lists India's subscription at USD 8,367.3 million or 8.5702 percent and voting power at 7.5268 percent.
- Verdict: India in AIIB matters because a large stake gives India voice and access while preserving the need for project-level evaluation.

CORE SESSION 58 - AIIB project and partnership model

VISUAL FIRST

AIIB PROJECT AND PARTNERSHIP MODEL

infrastructure gap -> appraisal -> AIIB/partner finance -> implementation

BOUNDARY -> Partner standards and institutional responsibility must be identified project by project.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

AIIB finances sovereign-backed and nonsovereign infrastructure through loans, guarantees, equity and co-financing.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: AIIB project and partnership model matters because co-financing can scale resources and harmonise standards while building institutional experience.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: sovereign-backed, nonsovereign, co-financing, green infrastructure, connectivity

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** AIIB project and partnership model matters because co-financing can scale resources and harmonise standards while building institutional experience.
- **Named evidence:** AIIB official material emphasises collaboration with other MDBs and investment in green, connected, technology-enabled and private-capital-mobilising infrastructure.
- **Analysis:** Co-financing can scale resources and harmonise standards while building institutional experience.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Partner standards and institutional responsibility must be identified project by project.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** AIIB official material emphasises collaboration with other MDBs and investment in green, connected, technology-enabled and private-capital-mobilising infrastructure.
- **Analytical inference:** Co-financing can scale resources and harmonise standards while building institutional experience.
- **Qualification:** Partner standards and institutional responsibility must be identified project by project.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not assume co-financing makes AIIB and World Bank governance identical.

MAINS USE

Evaluate additionality, standards and debt implications.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: AIIB finances sovereign-backed and nonsovereign infrastructure through loans, guarantees, equity and co-financing.
- Evidence anchor: AIIB official material emphasises collaboration with other MDBs and investment in green, connected, technology-enabled and private-capital-mobilising infrastructure.
- Verdict: AIIB project and partnership model matters because co-financing can scale resources and harmonise standards while building institutional experience.

CORE SESSION 59 - NDB origin and mandate

VISUAL FIRST

NDB ORIGIN AND MANDATE

2014 agreement -> 2015 legal establishment -> 2016 operations -> expansion

BOUNDARY -> Uruguay, Colombia, Ethiopia, Angola and Zimbabwe were prospective at the cutoff and become members only after depositing accession instruments.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

NDB was established by the five BRICS founders to mobilise resources for infrastructure and sustainable development in members and other emerging and developing economies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: NDB origin and mandate matters because member expansion broadens capital and development reach beyond the founding BRICS.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: NDB, BRICS, infrastructure, sustainable development, accession

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** NDB origin and mandate matters because member expansion broadens capital and development reach beyond the founding BRICS.
- **Named evidence:** The founding members are Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa; the official member page lists Bangladesh, UAE, Egypt, Algeria and Uzbekistan as full new members by 5 June 2026.
- **Analysis:** Member expansion broadens capital and development reach beyond the founding BRICS.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Uruguay, Colombia, Ethiopia, Angola and Zimbabwe were prospective at the cutoff and become members only after depositing accession instruments.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The founding members are Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa; the official member page lists Bangladesh, UAE, Egypt, Algeria and Uzbekistan as full new members by 5 June 2026.
- **Analytical inference:** Member expansion broadens capital and development reach beyond the founding BRICS.
- **Qualification:** Uruguay, Colombia, Ethiopia, Angola and Zimbabwe were prospective at the cutoff and become members only after depositing accession instruments.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not count prospective members as full members.

MAINS USE

Use admission, accession deposit and membership date as separate stages.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: NDB was established by the five BRICS founders to mobilise resources for infrastructure and sustainable development in members and other emerging and developing economies.
- Evidence anchor: The founding members are Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa; the official member page lists Bangladesh, UAE, Egypt, Algeria and Uzbekistan as full new members by 5 June 2026.
- Verdict: NDB origin and mandate matters because member expansion broadens capital and development reach beyond the founding BRICS.

CORE SESSION 60 - NDB capital and governance

VISUAL FIRST

NDB CAPITAL AND GOVERNANCE

subscription -> votes -> governors/directors -> project approval

BOUNDARY -> Equal founder shares do not mean equal borrowing, influence in every coalition or equal shares for new members.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

NDB voting is linked to subscribed shares, with equal founding subscriptions initially and safeguards against a single-member veto.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: NDB capital and governance matters because founding parity differentiates NDB from institutions with one dominant shareholder.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: subscribed shares, founder parity, USD 10 billion, 18.72 percent, no veto

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** NDB capital and governance matters because founding parity differentiates NDB from institutions with one dominant shareholder.
- **Named evidence:** The live NDB shareholding page checked 9 September 2026 lists each founder, including India, at 100,000 shares and USD 10 billion subscribed capital, equal to 18.72 percent after expansion.
- **Analysis:** Founding parity differentiates NDB from institutions with one dominant shareholder.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Equal founder shares do not mean equal borrowing, influence in every coalition or equal shares for new members.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The live NDB shareholding page checked 9 September 2026 lists each founder, including India, at 100,000 shares and USD 10 billion subscribed capital, equal to 18.72 percent after expansion.
- **Analytical inference:** Founding parity differentiates NDB from institutions with one dominant shareholder.
- **Qualification:** Equal founder shares do not mean equal borrowing, influence in every coalition or equal shares for new members.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not continue quoting 20 percent after membership expansion.

MAINS USE

Date the share table and distinguish founding design from current percentage.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: NDB voting is linked to subscribed shares, with equal founding subscriptions initially and safeguards against a single-member veto.
- Evidence anchor: The live NDB shareholding page checked 9 September 2026 lists each founder, including India, at 100,000 shares and USD 10 billion subscribed capital, equal to 18.72 percent after expansion.
- Verdict: NDB capital and governance matters because founding parity differentiates NDB from institutions with one dominant shareholder.

CORE SESSION 61 - NDB leadership and local-currency finance

VISUAL FIRST

NDB LEADERSHIP AND LOCAL-CURRENCY FINANCE

member demand -> local/global funding -> project loan -> currency-risk allocation

BOUNDARY -> Local funding is not available in every market or project and can carry domestic interest-rate risk.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

NDB seeks infrastructure and sustainable-development additionality, including local-currency financing where feasible.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: NDB leadership and local-currency finance matters because local-currency finance can reduce borrower exchange-rate mismatch and deepen domestic capital markets.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Dilma Rousseff, local currency, currency mismatch, capital market

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** NDB leadership and local-currency finance matters because local-currency finance can reduce borrower exchange-rate mismatch and deepen domestic capital markets.
- **Named evidence:** Dilma Rousseff was re-elected on 19 March 2025 for a term from 7 July 2025 to 6 July 2030.
- **Analysis:** Local-currency finance can reduce borrower exchange-rate mismatch and deepen domestic capital markets.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Local funding is not available in every market or project and can carry domestic interest-rate risk.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Dilma Rousseff was re-elected on 19 March 2025 for a term from 7 July 2025 to 6 July 2030.
- **Analytical inference:** Local-currency finance can reduce borrower exchange-rate mismatch and deepen domestic capital markets.
- **Qualification:** Local funding is not available in every market or project and can carry domestic interest-rate risk.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not claim NDB lending is free of all policy, procurement or safeguard requirements.

MAINS USE

Use currency denomination and development result, not rhetoric, to assess NDB value.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: NDB seeks infrastructure and sustainable-development additionality, including local-currency financing where feasible.
- Evidence anchor: Dilma Rousseff was re-elected on 19 March 2025 for a term from 7 July 2025 to 6 July 2030.
- Verdict: NDB leadership and local-currency finance matters because local-currency finance can reduce borrower exchange-rate mismatch and deepen domestic capital markets.

CORE SESSION 62 - India in NDB

VISUAL FIRST

INDIA IN NDB

founder capital -> board voice -> Indian projects -> repayment/results

BOUNDARY -> A project approved for India is not proof of disbursement, additionality or successful completion.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

India combines equal founding subscription with borrowing and governance participation in NDB.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: India in NDB matters because the institution diversifies India's development-finance partnerships and supports South-South cooperation.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: India, founder, shareholder, borrower, South-South cooperation

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** India in NDB matters because the institution diversifies India's development-finance partnerships and supports South-South cooperation.
- **Named evidence:** The official current table gives India USD 10 billion subscribed capital and 18.72 percent of total subscribed capital at the cutoff.
- **Analysis:** The institution diversifies India's development-finance partnerships and supports South-South cooperation.
- **Qualification / demand link:** A project approved for India is not proof of disbursement, additionality or successful completion.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The official current table gives India USD 10 billion subscribed capital and 18.72 percent of total subscribed capital at the cutoff.
- **Analytical inference:** The institution diversifies India's development-finance partnerships and supports South-South cooperation.
- **Qualification:** A project approved for India is not proof of disbursement, additionality or successful completion.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not equate shareholder status with grant finance.

MAINS USE

Assess India through governance, project quality, currency and outcomes.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: India combines equal founding subscription with borrowing and governance participation in NDB.
- Evidence anchor: The official current table gives India USD 10 billion subscribed capital and 18.72 percent of total subscribed capital at the cutoff.
- Verdict: India in NDB matters because the institution diversifies India's development-finance partnerships and supports South-South cooperation.

CORE SESSION 63 - Comparing ADB, AIIB and NDB

VISUAL FIRST

COMPARING ADB, AIIB AND NDB

ADB regional development | AIIB infrastructure | NDB BRICS-founded development

BOUNDARY -> Different mandates overlap, and raw member or capital counts do not measure project quality.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

ADB, AIIB and NDB are distinct MDBs differentiated by origin, membership, governance, regional scope and strategic emphasis.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Comparing ADB, AIIB and NDB matters because plural institutions expand financing choice, competition and co-financing possibilities.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: ADB, AIIB, NDB, regional, infrastructure, BRICS, complementarity

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Comparing ADB, AIIB and NDB matters because plural institutions expand financing choice, competition and co-financing possibilities.
- **Named evidence:** ADB dates from 1966 and has 69 members; AIIB began operations in 2016 with 111 approved members; NDB began operations in 2016 and had ten full members at the cutoff.
- **Analysis:** Plural institutions expand financing choice, competition and co-financing possibilities.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Different mandates overlap, and raw member or capital counts do not measure project quality.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** ADB dates from 1966 and has 69 members; AIIB began operations in 2016 with 111 approved members; NDB began operations in 2016 and had ten full members at the cutoff.
- **Analytical inference:** Plural institutions expand financing choice, competition and co-financing possibilities.
- **Qualification:** Different mandates overlap, and raw member or capital counts do not measure project quality.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not say newer MDBs have replaced the World Bank or ADB.

MAINS USE

Compare mandate, borrower, capital, governance, instrument and India stake.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: ADB, AIIB and NDB are distinct MDBs differentiated by origin, membership, governance, regional scope and strategic emphasis.
- Evidence anchor: ADB dates from 1966 and has 69 members; AIIB began operations in 2016 with 111 approved members; NDB began operations in 2016 and had ten full members at the cutoff.
- Verdict: Comparing ADB, AIIB and NDB matters because plural institutions expand financing choice, competition and co-financing possibilities.

CORE SESSION 64 - Liquidity crisis versus development gap

VISUAL FIRST

LIQUIDITY CRISIS VERSUS DEVELOPMENT GAP

liquidity gap -> IMF | development gap -> MDB | insolvency -> restructuring

BOUNDARY -> Liquidity and solvency can coexist, requiring financing plus debt treatment and reform.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

A liquidity crisis is an inability to meet near-term external payments; a development gap is a shortage of long-term capital, infrastructure or capability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Liquidity crisis versus development gap matters because correct diagnosis prevents long-term project lending from being used as short-term reserve support or vice versa.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: liquidity, solvency, development gap, maturity mismatch, restructuring

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Liquidity crisis versus development gap matters because correct diagnosis prevents long-term project lending from being used as short-term reserve support or vice versa.
- **Named evidence:** IMF facilities, World Bank Group finance and sovereign debt frameworks target different problems.
- **Analysis:** Correct diagnosis prevents long-term project lending from being used as short-term reserve support or vice versa.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Liquidity and solvency can coexist, requiring financing plus debt treatment and reform.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF facilities, World Bank Group finance and sovereign debt frameworks target different problems.
- **Analytical inference:** Correct diagnosis prevents long-term project lending from being used as short-term reserve support or vice versa.
- **Qualification:** Liquidity and solvency can coexist, requiring financing plus debt treatment and reform.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not prescribe an infrastructure loan for an immediate reserve run.

MAINS USE

Begin with liquidity, solvency and development diagnosis.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** A liquidity crisis is an inability to meet near-term external payments; a development gap is a shortage of long-term capital, infrastructure or capability.
- **Evidence anchor:** IMF facilities, World Bank Group finance and sovereign debt frameworks target different problems.
- **Verdict:** Liquidity crisis versus development gap matters because correct diagnosis prevents long-term project lending from being used as short-term reserve support or vice versa.

CORE SESSION 65 - Infrastructure lending comparison

VISUAL FIRST

INFRASTRUCTURE LENDING COMPARISON

project preparation -> finance -> construction -> service -> repayment

BOUNDARY -> Institution name does not make an unbankable or socially harmful project viable.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Infrastructure finance combines long maturity, construction risk, demand risk, safeguards and often sovereign or regulatory commitments.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Infrastructure lending comparison matters because the suitable institution depends on borrower, risk allocation, currency and additionality.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: infrastructure, long maturity, construction risk, guarantee, lifecycle

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Infrastructure lending comparison matters because the suitable institution depends on borrower, risk allocation, currency and additionality.
- **Named evidence:** IBRD, ADB, AIIB and NDB can all finance infrastructure, while IFC and MIGA can mobilise private participation through investment and guarantees.
- **Analysis:** The suitable institution depends on borrower, risk allocation, currency and additionality.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Institution name does not make an unbankable or socially harmful project viable.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IBRD, ADB, AIIB and NDB can all finance infrastructure, while IFC and MIGA can mobilise private participation through investment and guarantees.
- **Analytical inference:** The suitable institution depends on borrower, risk allocation, currency and additionality.
- **Qualification:** Institution name does not make an unbankable or socially harmful project viable.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not compare infrastructure banks by approval volume alone.

MAINS USE

Use lifecycle service quality and fiscal risk as the verdict.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Infrastructure finance combines long maturity, construction risk, demand risk, safeguards and often sovereign or regulatory commitments.
- Evidence anchor: IBRD, ADB, AIIB and NDB can all finance infrastructure, while IFC and MIGA can mobilise private participation through investment and guarantees.
- Verdict: Infrastructure lending comparison matters because the suitable institution depends on borrower, risk allocation, currency and additionality.

CORE SESSION 66 - Global financial safety net layers

VISUAL FIRST

GLOBAL FINANCIAL SAFETY NET LAYERS

self-insurance -> bilateral liquidity -> regional pool -> global pool

BOUNDARY -> Availability is unequal and coordination can be slow; not every swap is a crisis guarantee.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The global financial safety net combines national reserves, bilateral swap lines, regional financing arrangements and IMF resources.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Global financial safety net layers matters because layering can provide speed, scale and risk sharing across different shocks.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: GFSN, reserves, swap line, RFA, IMF, uneven access

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Global financial safety net layers matters because layering can provide speed, scale and risk sharing across different shocks.
- **Named evidence:** The IMF's October 2025 stocktaking uses these four layers and notes uneven access.
- **Analysis:** Layering can provide speed, scale and risk sharing across different shocks.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Availability is unequal and coordination can be slow; not every swap is a crisis guarantee.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The IMF's October 2025 stocktaking uses these four layers and notes uneven access.
- **Analytical inference:** Layering can provide speed, scale and risk sharing across different shocks.
- **Qualification:** Availability is unequal and coordination can be slow; not every swap is a crisis guarantee.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not count all announced swap lines as immediately drawable reserves.

MAINS USE

Compare coverage, conditionality, currency, speed and predictability.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The global financial safety net combines national reserves, bilateral swap lines, regional financing arrangements and IMF resources.
- Evidence anchor: The IMF's October 2025 stocktaking uses these four layers and notes uneven access.
- Verdict: Global financial safety net layers matters because layering can provide speed, scale and risk sharing across different shocks.

CORE SESSION 67 - Foreign-exchange reserves as self-insurance

VISUAL FIRST

FOREIGN-EXCHANGE RESERVES AS SELF-INSURANCE

current-account/capital shock -> reserve use -> adjustment time

BOUNDARY -> Accumulation has fiscal and opportunity costs and may be inadequate against a large solvency shock.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Official reserves are liquid external assets held by monetary authorities to meet intervention, payment and confidence needs.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Foreign-exchange reserves as self-insurance matters because reserves provide fast national control and reduce reliance on external approval.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: self-insurance, liquidity, reserve adequacy, opportunity cost

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Foreign-exchange reserves as self-insurance matters because reserves provide fast national control and reduce reliance on external approval.
- **Named evidence:** Topic 19 establishes that reserves include foreign currency assets, gold, SDRs and the reserve tranche position.
- **Analysis:** Reserves provide fast national control and reduce reliance on external approval.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Accumulation has fiscal and opportunity costs and may be inadequate against a large solvency shock.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Topic 19 establishes that reserves include foreign currency assets, gold, SDRs and the reserve tranche position.
- **Analytical inference:** Reserves provide fast national control and reduce reliance on external approval.
- **Qualification:** Accumulation has fiscal and opportunity costs and may be inadequate against a large solvency shock.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not compare a reserve stock directly with annual MDB commitments.

MAINS USE

Keep the reserve detail in Topic 19 and use only its safety-net role here.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Official reserves are liquid external assets held by monetary authorities to meet intervention, payment and confidence needs.
- Evidence anchor: Topic 19 establishes that reserves include foreign currency assets, gold, SDRs and the reserve tranche position.
- Verdict: Foreign-exchange reserves as self-insurance matters because reserves provide fast national control and reduce reliance on external approval.

CORE SESSION 68 - Regional financing arrangements

VISUAL FIRST

REGIONAL FINANCING ARRANGEMENTS

regional contributions -> surveillance/activation -> crisis facility

BOUNDARY -> Activation rules, currency coverage and IMF links vary; many facilities remain lightly used.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Regional financing arrangements pool member resources for crisis support within a regional agreement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Regional financing arrangements matters because regional knowledge and shared interest can complement the IMF and increase available resources.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: RFA, ESM, CMIM, pooled resources, crisis support

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Regional financing arrangements matters because regional knowledge and shared interest can complement the IMF and increase available resources.
- **Named evidence:** Examples include the European Stability Mechanism and Chiang Mai Initiative Multilateralisation.
- **Analysis:** Regional knowledge and shared interest can complement the IMF and increase available resources.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Activation rules, currency coverage and IMF links vary; many facilities remain lightly used.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Examples include the European Stability Mechanism and Chiang Mai Initiative Multilateralisation.
- **Analytical inference:** Regional knowledge and shared interest can complement the IMF and increase available resources.
- **Qualification:** Activation rules, currency coverage and IMF links vary; many facilities remain lightly used.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call every regional development bank a regional crisis-financing arrangement.

MAINS USE

Distinguish an RFA from an MDB by purpose and activation.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Regional financing arrangements pool member resources for crisis support within a regional agreement.
- Evidence anchor: Examples include the European Stability Mechanism and Chiang Mai Initiative Multilateralisation.
- Verdict: Regional financing arrangements matters because regional knowledge and shared interest can complement the IMF and increase available resources.

CORE SESSION 69 - Bilateral central-bank swaps

VISUAL FIRST

BILATERAL CENTRAL-BANK SWAPS

central-bank agreement -> currency exchange -> domestic liquidity -> reversal

BOUNDARY -> Access is selective, temporary and currency-specific; it does not automatically finance a fiscal deficit.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

A bilateral swap line permits two central banks to exchange currencies under agreed terms to supply liquidity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Bilateral central-bank swaps matters because swaps can rapidly relieve key-currency funding stress and limit contagion.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: bilateral swap, central bank, liquidity, selectivity, reversal

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Bilateral central-bank swaps matters because swaps can rapidly relieve key-currency funding stress and limit contagion.
- **Named evidence:** IMF safety-net analysis treats bilateral swaps as a distinct layer alongside reserves, RFAs and Fund resources.
- **Analysis:** Swaps can rapidly relieve key-currency funding stress and limit contagion.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Access is selective, temporary and currency-specific; it does not automatically finance a fiscal deficit.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF safety-net analysis treats bilateral swaps as a distinct layer alongside reserves, RFAs and Fund resources.
- **Analytical inference:** Swaps can rapidly relieve key-currency funding stress and limit contagion.
- **Qualification:** Access is selective, temporary and currency-specific; it does not automatically finance a fiscal deficit.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call a swap an unconditional permanent transfer.

MAINS USE

Explain counterparties, currency, maturity and repayment.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: A bilateral swap line permits two central banks to exchange currencies under agreed terms to supply liquidity.
- Evidence anchor: IMF safety-net analysis treats bilateral swaps as a distinct layer alongside reserves, RFAs and Fund resources.
- Verdict: Bilateral central-bank swaps matters because swaps can rapidly relieve key-currency funding stress and limit contagion.

CORE SESSION 70 - G20 origin and membership

VISUAL FIRST

G20 ORIGIN AND MEMBERSHIP

Asian crisis -> 1999 finance forum -> 2008 leaders -> broader agenda

BOUNDARY -> Its representativeness remains incomplete and presidency priorities rotate annually.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The G20 is an informal forum for international economic cooperation created at finance-minister level in 1999 and elevated to leaders' level during the global financial crisis.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: G20 origin and membership matters because the forum concentrates major economies and can coordinate responses faster than universal treaty bodies.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: G20, 1999, leaders, EU, AU, US presidency 2026

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** G20 origin and membership matters because the forum concentrates major economies and can coordinate responses faster than universal treaty bodies.
- **Named evidence:** The current G20 comprises 19 countries, the European Union and the African Union; the United States holds the 2026 presidency.
- **Analysis:** The forum concentrates major economies and can coordinate responses faster than universal treaty bodies.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Its representativeness remains incomplete and presidency priorities rotate annually.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The current G20 comprises 19 countries, the European Union and the African Union; the United States holds the 2026 presidency.
- **Analytical inference:** The forum concentrates major economies and can coordinate responses faster than universal treaty bodies.
- **Qualification:** Its representativeness remains incomplete and presidency priorities rotate annually.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call the G20 a treaty organisation with universal membership.

MAINS USE

Use it as a coordination forum, not a supranational legislature.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The G20 is an informal forum for international economic cooperation created at finance-minister level in 1999 and elevated to leaders' level during the global financial crisis.
- Evidence anchor: The current G20 comprises 19 countries, the European Union and the African Union; the United States holds the 2026 presidency.
- Verdict: G20 origin and membership matters because the forum concentrates major economies and can coordinate responses faster than universal treaty bodies.

CORE SESSION 71 - G20 Finance Track

VISUAL FIRST

G20 FINANCE TRACK

presidency agenda -> deputies/working groups -> FMCBG -> leaders

BOUNDARY -> Finance Track conclusions are generally commitments and coordination signals, not self-executing law.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The Finance Track is the G20 stream led by finance ministries and central banks on macroeconomic, financial, tax, debt and development-finance issues.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: G20 Finance Track matters because technical groups can build shared diagnostics and political consensus before leaders endorse outcomes.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Finance Track, FMCBG, deputies, working group, communique

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** G20 Finance Track matters because technical groups can build shared diagnostics and political consensus before leaders endorse outcomes.
- **Named evidence:** Official G20 material identifies Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors meetings as a core part of the process.
- **Analysis:** Technical groups can build shared diagnostics and political consensus before leaders endorse outcomes.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Finance Track conclusions are generally commitments and coordination signals, not self-executing law.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Official G20 material identifies Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors meetings as a core part of the process.
- **Analytical inference:** Technical groups can build shared diagnostics and political consensus before leaders endorse outcomes.
- **Qualification:** Finance Track conclusions are generally commitments and coordination signals, not self-executing law.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not assign Sherpa Track social and diplomatic issues entirely to finance officials.

MAINS USE

Trace the route from working group to communique and national action.

MINI RECAP

- **Definition:** The Finance Track is the G20 stream led by finance ministries and central banks on macroeconomic, financial, tax, debt and development-finance issues.
- **Evidence anchor:** Official G20 material identifies Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors meetings as a core part of the process.
- **Verdict:** G20 Finance Track matters because technical groups can build shared diagnostics and political consensus before leaders endorse outcomes.

CORE SESSION 72 - G20 consensus and non-treaty status

VISUAL FIRST

G20 CONSENSUS AND NON-TREATY STATUS

rotating presidency -> agenda/meetings -> consensus -> voluntary implementation

BOUNDARY -> Political commitments can still shape IMF, MDB, FSB and national agendas.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

G20 decisions are reached by consensus in an informal forum without a permanent treaty secretariat.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: G20 consensus and non-treaty status matters because flexibility supports rapid coordination but weakens legal enforcement and institutional memory.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: consensus, informal forum, rotating presidency, non-binding, implementation

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** G20 consensus and non-treaty status matters because flexibility supports rapid coordination but weakens legal enforcement and institutional memory.
- **Named evidence:** The official 2026 G20 site describes the forum as informal, consensus-based and without a permanent secretariat.
- **Analysis:** Flexibility supports rapid coordination but weakens legal enforcement and institutional memory.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Political commitments can still shape IMF, MDB, FSB and national agendas.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The official 2026 G20 site describes the forum as informal, consensus-based and without a permanent secretariat.
- **Analytical inference:** Flexibility supports rapid coordination but weakens legal enforcement and institutional memory.
- **Qualification:** Political commitments can still shape IMF, MDB, FSB and national agendas.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call a G20 communique directly enforceable in Indian courts.

MAINS USE

Assess agenda-setting, peer pressure and implementation rather than treaty compliance.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: G20 decisions are reached by consensus in an informal forum without a permanent treaty secretariat.
- Evidence anchor: The official 2026 G20 site describes the forum as informal, consensus-based and without a permanent secretariat.
- Verdict: G20 consensus and non-treaty status matters because flexibility supports rapid coordination but weakens legal enforcement and institutional memory.

CORE SESSION 73 - DSSI and Common Framework

VISUAL FIRST

DSSI AND COMMON FRAMEWORK

DSSI pause -> expiry 2021 -> Common Framework request -> creditor committee -> treatment
BOUNDARY -> Slow cases, data gaps and coordination with private and non-Paris creditors limit effectiveness.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

DSSI temporarily suspended eligible debt service during 2020-21; the Common Framework seeks case-by-case restructuring beyond mere suspension.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: DSSI and Common Framework matters because broader creditor coordination can address debt stock and maturity rather than only near-term cash flow.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: DSSI, Common Framework, restructuring, creditor committee, comparable treatment

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** DSSI and Common Framework matters because broader creditor coordination can address debt stock and maturity rather than only near-term cash flow.
- **Named evidence:** The G20 and Paris Club launched the Common Framework in November 2020 for eligible low-income countries, with comparable treatment sought from other creditors.
- **Analysis:** Broader creditor coordination can address debt stock and maturity rather than only near-term cash flow.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Slow cases, data gaps and coordination with private and non-Paris creditors limit effectiveness.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The G20 and Paris Club launched the Common Framework in November 2020 for eligible low-income countries, with comparable treatment sought from other creditors.
- **Analytical inference:** Broader creditor coordination can address debt stock and maturity rather than only near-term cash flow.
- **Qualification:** Slow cases, data gaps and coordination with private and non-Paris creditors limit effectiveness.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not describe DSSI and the Common Framework as the same instrument.

MAINS USE

Contrast suspension, restructuring, eligibility and creditor coordination.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: DSSI temporarily suspended eligible debt service during 2020-21; the Common Framework seeks case-by-case restructuring beyond mere suspension.
- Evidence anchor: The G20 and Paris Club launched the Common Framework in November 2020 for eligible low-income countries, with comparable treatment sought from other creditors.
- Verdict: DSSI and Common Framework matters because broader creditor coordination can address debt stock and maturity rather than only near-term cash flow.

CORE SESSION 74 - Paris Club

VISUAL FIRST

PARIS CLUB

debtor request + IMF-supported programme -> creditor negotiation -> agreed minutes

BOUNDARY -> It is neither a treaty organisation nor the forum for all private creditors.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The Paris Club is an informal group of official bilateral creditors that coordinates sovereign debt treatments by consensus.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Paris Club matters because coordination reduces free riding and can align maturity or relief across official creditors.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: Paris Club, bilateral creditor, consensus, conditionality, comparability

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Paris Club matters because coordination reduces free riding and can align maturity or relief across official creditors.
- **Named evidence:** Its official site lists 22 permanent members and six operating principles: solidarity, consensus, information sharing, case-by-case treatment, conditionality and comparability.
- **Analysis:** Coordination reduces free riding and can align maturity or relief across official creditors.
- **Qualification / demand link:** It is neither a treaty organisation nor the forum for all private creditors.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** Its official site lists 22 permanent members and six operating principles: solidarity, consensus, information sharing, case-by-case treatment, conditionality and comparability.
- **Analytical inference:** Coordination reduces free riding and can align maturity or relief across official creditors.
- **Qualification:** It is neither a treaty organisation nor the forum for all private creditors.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not confuse Paris Club official creditors with London Club bank creditors.

MAINS USE

Use creditor type, IMF link and comparability principle.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The Paris Club is an informal group of official bilateral creditors that coordinates sovereign debt treatments by consensus.
- Evidence anchor: Its official site lists 22 permanent members and six operating principles: solidarity, consensus, information sharing, case-by-case treatment, conditionality and comparability.
- Verdict: Paris Club matters because coordination reduces free riding and can align maturity or relief across official creditors.

CORE SESSION 75 - BIS role

VISUAL FIRST

BIS ROLE

central-bank membership -> meetings/research/services -> cooperation

BOUNDARY -> Its publications and committee standards require national adoption to have domestic legal effect.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The Bank for International Settlements is a bank for central banks and a forum supporting monetary and financial cooperation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: BIS role matters because the BIS supplies a trusted platform, research and banking services without becoming a global central bank.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: BIS, central banks, Basel, research, banking services, cooperation

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** BIS role matters because the BIS supplies a trusted platform, research and banking services without becoming a global central bank.
- **Named evidence:** BIS official material states that it is owned by 63 central banks representing economies accounting for about 95 percent of world GDP.
- **Analysis:** The BIS supplies a trusted platform, research and banking services without becoming a global central bank.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Its publications and committee standards require national adoption to have domestic legal effect.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** BIS official material states that it is owned by 63 central banks representing economies accounting for about 95 percent of world GDP.
- **Analytical inference:** The BIS supplies a trusted platform, research and banking services without becoming a global central bank.
- **Qualification:** Its publications and committee standards require national adoption to have domestic legal effect.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call the BIS a lender to households or ordinary firms.

MAINS USE

Use it as institutional infrastructure for central-bank cooperation.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The Bank for International Settlements is a bank for central banks and a forum supporting monetary and financial cooperation.
- Evidence anchor: BIS official material states that it is owned by 63 central banks representing economies accounting for about 95 percent of world GDP.
- Verdict: BIS role matters because the BIS supplies a trusted platform, research and banking services without becoming a global central bank.

CORE SESSION 76 - Basel Committee on Banking Supervision

VISUAL FIRST

BASEL COMMITTEE ON BANKING SUPERVISION

supervisory problem -> Basel standard -> national rule -> monitoring

BOUNDARY -> Implementation timing and legal form differ by jurisdiction; Basel capital detail belongs to Topic 6.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

BCBS is the primary global standard setter for prudential bank regulation and a forum for supervisory cooperation hosted at the BIS.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Basel Committee on Banking Supervision matters because common standards can reduce regulatory arbitrage and strengthen comparability.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: BCBS, prudential standard, 45 members, 28 jurisdictions, no legal force

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Basel Committee on Banking Supervision matters because common standards can reduce regulatory arbitrage and strengthen comparability.
- **Named evidence:** BIS material lists 45 BCBS members from 28 jurisdictions and states that the Committee has no formal supranational authority or legal force.
- **Analysis:** Common standards can reduce regulatory arbitrage and strengthen comparability.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Implementation timing and legal form differ by jurisdiction; Basel capital detail belongs to Topic 6.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** BIS material lists 45 BCBS members from 28 jurisdictions and states that the Committee has no formal supranational authority or legal force.
- **Analytical inference:** Common standards can reduce regulatory arbitrage and strengthen comparability.
- **Qualification:** Implementation timing and legal form differ by jurisdiction; Basel capital detail belongs to Topic 6.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not treat a Basel standard as automatically enforceable Indian law.

MAINS USE

Bound the answer to standard setting, cooperation and national implementation.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: BCBS is the primary global standard setter for prudential bank regulation and a forum for supervisory cooperation hosted at the BIS.
- Evidence anchor: BIS material lists 45 BCBS members from 28 jurisdictions and states that the Committee has no formal supranational authority or legal force.
- Verdict: Basel Committee on Banking Supervision matters because common standards can reduce regulatory arbitrage and strengthen comparability.

CORE SESSION 77 - Financial Stability Board

VISUAL FIRST

FINANCIAL STABILITY BOARD

vulnerability assessment -> policy coordination -> standard/recommendation -> peer review

BOUNDARY -> FSB decisions are not legally binding and operate through national authorities, moral suasion and peer pressure.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The FSB monitors global financial vulnerabilities and coordinates national authorities and standard setters to promote coherent reform.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Financial Stability Board matters because coordination closes cross-border regulatory gaps and monitors implementation after crises.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: FSB, Plenary, Andrew Bailey, peer review, moral suasion

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Financial Stability Board matters because coordination closes cross-border regulatory gaps and monitors implementation after crises.
- **Named evidence:** The FSB page checked at the cutoff lists a Plenary of 59 representatives from 25 jurisdictions plus international institutions and standard-setting bodies; Andrew Bailey is Chair.
- **Analysis:** Coordination closes cross-border regulatory gaps and monitors implementation after crises.
- **Qualification / demand link:** FSB decisions are not legally binding and operate through national authorities, moral suasion and peer pressure.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The FSB page checked at the cutoff lists a Plenary of 59 representatives from 25 jurisdictions plus international institutions and standard-setting bodies; Andrew Bailey is Chair.
- **Analytical inference:** Coordination closes cross-border regulatory gaps and monitors implementation after crises.
- **Qualification:** FSB decisions are not legally binding and operate through national authorities, moral suasion and peer pressure.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not call the FSB a global financial regulator with direct enforcement power.

MAINS USE

Use vulnerability, coordination, implementation and peer-review functions.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The FSB monitors global financial vulnerabilities and coordinates national authorities and standard setters to promote coherent reform.
- Evidence anchor: The FSB page checked at the cutoff lists a Plenary of 59 representatives from 25 jurisdictions plus international institutions and standard-setting bodies; Andrew Bailey is Chair.
- Verdict: Financial Stability Board matters because coordination closes cross-border regulatory gaps and monitors implementation after crises.

CORE SESSION 78 - BIS, BCBS and FSB comparison

VISUAL FIRST

BIS, BCBS AND FSB COMPARISON

BIS platform | BCBS banking standards | FSB cross-sector coordination

BOUNDARY -> None is a supranational legislature; national regulators implement standards.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

BIS is the hosting and cooperation institution, BCBS sets bank-supervision standards, and FSB coordinates system-wide financial-stability policy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: BIS, BCBS and FSB comparison matters because institutional nesting supports coordination but does not merge mandates or memberships.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: BIS, BCBS, FSB, host, standard setter, coordinator

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** BIS, BCBS and FSB comparison matters because institutional nesting supports coordination but does not merge mandates or memberships.
- **Named evidence:** The FSB Secretariat is hosted by the BIS, while BCBS is a distinct BIS-hosted committee.
- **Analysis:** Institutional nesting supports coordination but does not merge mandates or memberships.
- **Qualification / demand link:** None is a supranational legislature; national regulators implement standards.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The FSB Secretariat is hosted by the BIS, while BCBS is a distinct BIS-hosted committee.
- **Analytical inference:** Institutional nesting supports coordination but does not merge mandates or memberships.
- **Qualification:** None is a supranational legislature; national regulators implement standards.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not say the FSB writes only bank-capital rules or that BIS and BCBS are identical.

MAINS USE

Use the three-column mandate-governance-output comparison.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: BIS is the hosting and cooperation institution, BCBS sets bank-supervision standards, and FSB coordinates system-wide financial-stability policy.
- Evidence anchor: The FSB Secretariat is hosted by the BIS, while BCBS is a distinct BIS-hosted committee.
- Verdict: BIS, BCBS and FSB comparison matters because institutional nesting supports coordination but does not merge mandates or memberships.

CORE SESSION 79 - Climate and development finance

VISUAL FIRST

CLIMATE AND DEVELOPMENT FINANCE

climate risk -> project/policy pipeline -> MDB finance -> measurable result

BOUNDARY -> Climate labels do not prove additionality, adaptation benefit or a just distribution.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Climate-development finance supports mitigation, adaptation, resilience and nature while preserving poverty-reduction and country-development objectives.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Climate and development finance matters because mDB balance sheets, guarantees and country platforms can mobilise long-horizon finance beyond public budgets.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: climate finance, adaptation, mitigation, country platform, measurement

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Climate and development finance matters because mDB balance sheets, guarantees and country platforms can mobilise long-horizon finance beyond public budgets.
- **Named evidence:** MDBs welcomed the November 2024 G20 Roadmap for better, bigger and more effective MDBs and adopted common approaches to climate-result measurement.
- **Analysis:** MDB balance sheets, guarantees and country platforms can mobilise long-horizon finance beyond public budgets.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Climate labels do not prove additionality, adaptation benefit or a just distribution.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** MDBs welcomed the November 2024 G20 Roadmap for better, bigger and more effective MDBs and adopted common approaches to climate-result measurement.
- **Analytical inference:** MDB balance sheets, guarantees and country platforms can mobilise long-horizon finance beyond public budgets.
- **Qualification:** Climate labels do not prove additionality, adaptation benefit or a just distribution.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not count every green-labelled commitment as verified emissions reduction.

MAINS USE

Test development additionality, climate integrity, debt and local ownership.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Climate-development finance supports mitigation, adaptation, resilience and nature while preserving poverty-reduction and country-development objectives.
- Evidence anchor: MDBs welcomed the November 2024 G20 Roadmap for better, bigger and more effective MDBs and adopted common approaches to climate-result measurement.
- Verdict: Climate and development finance matters because mDB balance sheets, guarantees and country platforms can mobilise long-horizon finance beyond public budgets.

CORE SESSION 80 - MDB reform agenda

VISUAL FIRST

MDB REFORM AGENDA

capital adequacy reform -> balance-sheet headroom -> better projects -> outcomes

BOUNDARY -> Bigger lending can worsen debt or safeguards if project quality and accountability weaken.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

MDB reform seeks greater lending capacity, faster delivery, stronger coordination, private-capital mobilisation and broader global-public-goods support.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: MDB reform agenda matters because capital optimisation and guarantees can expand capacity without abandoning risk discipline.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: MDB reform, capital adequacy, headroom, guarantees, effectiveness

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** MDB reform agenda matters because capital optimisation and guarantees can expand capacity without abandoning risk discipline.
- **Named evidence:** The G20-endorsed 2024 roadmap describes MDBs becoming better, bigger and more effective through coordinated reforms.
- **Analysis:** Capital optimisation and guarantees can expand capacity without abandoning risk discipline.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Bigger lending can worsen debt or safeguards if project quality and accountability weaken.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The G20-endorsed 2024 roadmap describes MDBs becoming better, bigger and more effective through coordinated reforms.
- **Analytical inference:** Capital optimisation and guarantees can expand capacity without abandoning risk discipline.
- **Qualification:** Bigger lending can worsen debt or safeguards if project quality and accountability weaken.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not measure reform only by a larger commitment envelope.

MAINS USE

Judge speed, additionality, leverage, safeguards, debt and results together.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: MDB reform seeks greater lending capacity, faster delivery, stronger coordination, private-capital mobilisation and broader global-public-goods support.
- Evidence anchor: The G20-endorsed 2024 roadmap describes MDBs becoming better, bigger and more effective through coordinated reforms.
- Verdict: MDB reform agenda matters because capital optimisation and guarantees can expand capacity without abandoning risk discipline.

CORE SESSION 81 - Voice, legitimacy and representation

VISUAL FIRST

VOICE, LEGITIMACY AND REPRESENTATION

representation gap -> trust deficit -> reform -> stronger cooperation

BOUNDARY -> Representation alone cannot substitute for transparent selection, accountability and operational performance.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Institutional legitimacy depends on whether governance reflects members' contemporary economic weight, contribution, vulnerability and stake in decisions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Voice, legitimacy and representation matters because greater emerging-economy voice can improve ownership and compliance with collective decisions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: voice, legitimacy, representation, quota reform, accountability

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Voice, legitimacy and representation matters because greater emerging-economy voice can improve ownership and compliance with collective decisions.
- **Named evidence:** IMF quota reform, World Bank shareholding debates and newer MDB governance provide distinct models of weighted representation.
- **Analysis:** Greater emerging-economy voice can improve ownership and compliance with collective decisions.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Representation alone cannot substitute for transparent selection, accountability and operational performance.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF quota reform, World Bank shareholding debates and newer MDB governance provide distinct models of weighted representation.
- **Analytical inference:** Greater emerging-economy voice can improve ownership and compliance with collective decisions.
- **Qualification:** Representation alone cannot substitute for transparent selection, accountability and operational performance.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not assume a newer institution is automatically more democratic.

MAINS USE

Use voice, resources, accountability and results as four reform tests.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Institutional legitimacy depends on whether governance reflects members' contemporary economic weight, contribution, vulnerability and stake in decisions.
- Evidence anchor: IMF quota reform, World Bank shareholding debates and newer MDB governance provide distinct models of weighted representation.
- Verdict: Voice, legitimacy and representation matters because greater emerging-economy voice can improve ownership and compliance with collective decisions.

CORE SESSION 82 - Conditionality debate

VISUAL FIRST

CONDITIONALITY DEBATE

finance need -> conditions -> implementation -> review -> continuation

BOUNDARY -> Poor design can be pro-cyclical, distributionally harmful, intrusive or beyond institutional expertise.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Conditionality is the linking of finance or debt treatment to specified policy, fiduciary or performance requirements.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Conditionality debate matters because conditions can safeguard pooled resources and correct policy weaknesses.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: conditionality, covenant, criticality, ownership, sequencing

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Conditionality debate matters because conditions can safeguard pooled resources and correct policy weaknesses.
- **Named evidence:** IMF programme conditions, MDB project covenants and Paris Club IMF-program requirements operate through different legal and economic channels.
- **Analysis:** Conditions can safeguard pooled resources and correct policy weaknesses.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Poor design can be pro-cyclical, distributionally harmful, intrusive or beyond institutional expertise.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF programme conditions, MDB project covenants and Paris Club IMF-program requirements operate through different legal and economic channels.
- **Analytical inference:** Conditions can safeguard pooled resources and correct policy weaknesses.
- **Qualification:** Poor design can be pro-cyclical, distributionally harmful, intrusive or beyond institutional expertise.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not use one blanket judgment for macro conditionality, procurement rules and safeguards.

MAINS USE

Assess criticality, sequencing, ownership, social protection and review.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Conditionality is the linking of finance or debt treatment to specified policy, fiduciary or performance requirements.
- Evidence anchor: IMF programme conditions, MDB project covenants and Paris Club IMF-program requirements operate through different legal and economic channels.
- Verdict: Conditionality debate matters because conditions can safeguard pooled resources and correct policy weaknesses.

CORE SESSION 83 - Development policy debate

VISUAL FIRST

DEVELOPMENT POLICY DEBATE

external finance/knowledge -> domestic institutions -> investment/reform -> outcomes

BOUNDARY -> Advice can reflect lender incentives, weak local knowledge or ideological fashion; domestic institutions remain decisive.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Development-finance debate concerns whether external institutions support country-owned transformation or impose standardised models and debt burdens.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Development policy debate matters because knowledge and long maturities can overcome market failures and coordination gaps.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: development model, policy ownership, state capacity, knowledge, debt

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Development policy debate matters because knowledge and long maturities can overcome market failures and coordination gaps.
- **Named evidence:** World Bank and MDB frameworks combine finance with technical assistance, safeguards and results measurement.
- **Analysis:** Knowledge and long maturities can overcome market failures and coordination gaps.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Advice can reflect lender incentives, weak local knowledge or ideological fashion; domestic institutions remain decisive.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** World Bank and MDB frameworks combine finance with technical assistance, safeguards and results measurement.
- **Analytical inference:** Knowledge and long maturities can overcome market failures and coordination gaps.
- **Qualification:** Advice can reflect lender incentives, weak local knowledge or ideological fashion; domestic institutions remain decisive.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not attribute national development success or failure to one lender alone.

MAINS USE

Use counterfactual, ownership, capacity and distribution.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Development-finance debate concerns whether external institutions support country-owned transformation or impose standardised models and debt burdens.
- Evidence anchor: World Bank and MDB frameworks combine finance with technical assistance, safeguards and results measurement.
- Verdict: Development policy debate matters because knowledge and long maturities can overcome market failures and coordination gaps.

CORE SESSION 84 - Crisis coordination and early warning

VISUAL FIRST

CRISIS COORDINATION AND EARLY WARNING

risk signal -> IMF/FSB assessment -> G20 coordination -> national action

BOUNDARY -> Warnings are probabilistic and can fail because of data, incentives or political delay.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

Global crisis prevention links surveillance, vulnerability assessment, central-bank cooperation and coordinated financing before and during shocks.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Crisis coordination and early warning matters because combining macroeconomic and financial-system lenses can identify feedback loops and contagion.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: early warning, vulnerability, contagion, IMF, FSB, coordination

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Crisis coordination and early warning matters because combining macroeconomic and financial-system lenses can identify feedback loops and contagion.
- **Named evidence:** The IMF and FSB conduct an Early Warning Exercise, while BIS-hosted forums support central-bank information exchange.
- **Analysis:** Combining macroeconomic and financial-system lenses can identify feedback loops and contagion.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Warnings are probabilistic and can fail because of data, incentives or political delay.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** The IMF and FSB conduct an Early Warning Exercise, while BIS-hosted forums support central-bank information exchange.
- **Analytical inference:** Combining macroeconomic and financial-system lenses can identify feedback loops and contagion.
- **Qualification:** Warnings are probabilistic and can fail because of data, incentives or political delay.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not present an early-warning report as a forecast certainty.

MAINS USE

Explain information, coordination, action and residual uncertainty.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: Global crisis prevention links surveillance, vulnerability assessment, central-bank cooperation and coordinated financing before and during shocks.
- Evidence anchor: The IMF and FSB conduct an Early Warning Exercise, while BIS-hosted forums support central-bank information exchange.
- Verdict: Crisis coordination and early warning matters because combining macroeconomic and financial-system lenses can identify feedback loops and contagion.

CORE SESSION 85 - India's multi-institution strategy

VISUAL FIRST

INDIA'S MULTI-INSTITUTION STRATEGY

IMF/WBG + ADB + AIIB + NDB + G20 -> finance + standards + reform voice

BOUNDARY -> Membership does not imply acceptance of every policy, active borrowing from every window or equal influence.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

India engages legacy and newer institutions simultaneously to secure stability, development finance, voice and diversified partnerships.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: India's multi-institution strategy matters because portfolio engagement can combine global scale, regional expertise and greater voice in newer institutions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: India, strategic pluralism, shareholder, borrower, reform voice, ICSID

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** India's multi-institution strategy matters because portfolio engagement can combine global scale, regional expertise and greater voice in newer institutions.
- **Named evidence:** At the cutoff India is an IMF and World Bank Group shareholder, an ADB founding member, AIIB's second-largest shareholder and an equal-subscription NDB founder, while remaining outside the ICSID Convention.
- **Analysis:** Portfolio engagement can combine global scale, regional expertise and greater voice in newer institutions.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Membership does not imply acceptance of every policy, active borrowing from every window or equal influence.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** At the cutoff India is an IMF and World Bank Group shareholder, an ADB founding member, AIIB's second-largest shareholder and an equal-subscription NDB founder, while remaining outside the ICSID Convention.
- **Analytical inference:** Portfolio engagement can combine global scale, regional expertise and greater voice in newer institutions.
- **Qualification:** Membership does not imply acceptance of every policy, active borrowing from every window or equal influence.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not infer India has an IMF programme or ICSID membership from institutional participation.

MAINS USE

Conclude with strategic pluralism plus project and governance discipline.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: India engages legacy and newer institutions simultaneously to secure stability, development finance, voice and diversified partnerships.
- Evidence anchor: At the cutoff India is an IMF and World Bank Group shareholder, an ADB founding member, AIIB's second-largest shareholder and an equal-subscription NDB founder, while remaining outside the ICSID Convention.
- Verdict: India's multi-institution strategy matters because portfolio engagement can combine global scale, regional expertise and greater voice in newer institutions.

CORE SESSION 86 - Final institutional decision matrix

VISUAL FIRST

FINAL INSTITUTIONAL DECISION MATRIX

diagnose problem -> choose institution/instrument -> assess governance -> test outcome

BOUNDARY -> Real cases may require several institutions, and coordination costs must be recognised.

Visual reading: Identify the institution, resource or rule first; then trace authority, transmission, risk and implementation.

DEFINITION

The correct institution follows from the problem: liquidity, macro adjustment, sovereign development, private investment, guarantee, arbitration, infrastructure or regulatory coordination.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE: Final institutional decision matrix matters because a decision matrix prevents acronym recall from replacing economic diagnosis.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS: diagnosis, mandate, instrument, risk, accountability, coordination

HOW TO WRITE THE ANSWER PARAGRAPH

- **Claim:** Final institutional decision matrix matters because a decision matrix prevents acronym recall from replacing economic diagnosis.
- **Named evidence:** IMF, five World Bank Group institutions, ADB, AIIB, NDB, G20, Paris Club, BIS, BCBS and FSB occupy different cells of this matrix.
- **Analysis:** A decision matrix prevents acronym recall from replacing economic diagnosis.
- **Qualification / demand link:** Real cases may require several institutions, and coordination costs must be recognised.

EVIDENCE AND INFERENCE

- **Fact/evidence:** IMF, five World Bank Group institutions, ADB, AIIB, NDB, G20, Paris Club, BIS, BCBS and FSB occupy different cells of this matrix.
- **Analytical inference:** A decision matrix prevents acronym recall from replacing economic diagnosis.
- **Qualification:** Real cases may require several institutions, and coordination costs must be recognised.

PRELIMS TRAP

Do not recommend one institution as a universal solution.

MAINS USE

End answers by matching mandate, instrument, risk and accountability.

MINI RECAP

- Definition: The correct institution follows from the problem: liquidity, macro adjustment, sovereign development, private investment, guarantee, arbitration, infrastructure or regulatory coordination.
- Evidence anchor: IMF, five World Bank Group institutions, ADB, AIIB, NDB, G20, Paris Club, BIS, BCBS and FSB occupy different cells of this matrix.
- Verdict: Final institutional decision matrix matters because a decision matrix prevents acronym recall from replacing economic diagnosis.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED

Advanced 1 - Quota formula and representation

GDP + openness + variability + reserves -> compression -> calculated quota share

The IMF quota formula is an input to negotiation, not an automatic allocation rule. Market and purchasing-power-parity GDP, openness, variability and reserves are combined and compressed; political agreement, minimum shares and ratification determine actual outcomes. A technically updated formula can still fail to deliver redistribution if the review is equiproportional.

Advanced 2 - SDR balance-sheet logic

allocation creates SDR holding + matching allocation liability
holding below allocation -> net charge | above allocation -> net interest

An allocation increases gross reserve assets but also creates a long-term allocation liability. The SDR interest rate applies symmetrically to holdings and allocations, so a member pays net charges after exchanging SDRs and holding fewer than allocated. This is why allocation is neither a fiscal grant nor ordinary IMF credit.

Advanced 3 - MDB leverage and callable capital

paid-in capital + retained earnings + callable backing -> market borrowing -> loans

MDBs magnify shareholder capital by borrowing against strong balance sheets. Capital-adequacy reform can release headroom through risk transfer, portfolio guarantees and revised limits, but excessive leverage can weaken ratings and raise funding costs. Callable capital is a remote shareholder commitment, not cash available for routine disbursement.

Advanced 4 - Preferred creditor treatment

MDB claims often receive de facto priority because borrowers seek continuing access and shareholders protect institutional balance sheets. This convention can lower funding cost, yet it complicates burden sharing in sovereign restructuring and is not identical to a universal statutory lien.

Advanced 5 - Institutional competition versus regime complexity

New MDBs can improve borrower choice, governance voice and experimentation. They can also create duplicated appraisal, inconsistent safeguards and creditor-coordination problems. The policy goal is interoperable standards and co-financing without cartelisation or a race to the bottom.

Advanced 6 - Global public goods and mandate expansion

Climate stability, pandemic preparedness and cross-border resilience produce benefits beyond one borrower. MDB reform therefore seeks finance for global challenges while protecting country ownership and poverty reduction. The tension is allocation: scarce concessional resources should not be diverted from the poorest merely because global benefits are large.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Core decision tree

SHORT-TERM EXTERNAL GAP -> IMF surveillance/lending
 LONG-TERM SOVEREIGN DEVELOPMENT -> IBRD/IDA/ADB/AIIB/NDB
 PRIVATE ENTERPRISE -> IFC or nonsovereign MDB window
 POLITICAL-RISK TRANSFER -> MIGA/guarantee
 INVESTMENT DISPUTE -> consent-based ICSID route
 SOVEREIGN DEBT TREATMENT -> Paris Club/Common Framework
 SYSTEMIC FINANCIAL STANDARD -> BIS-hosted BCBS / FSB coordination
 POLITICAL ECONOMIC COORDINATION -> G20

Prelims master comparison

Institution/instrument	Core function	Decisive trap
IMF	Surveillance and balance-of-payments support	Not infrastructure project finance
SDR	Reserve asset and unit of account	Not currency, grant or loan
Reserve tranche	Member's liquid IMF reserve claim	Not conditional programme credit
IBRD	Market-funded sovereign development finance	Not the concessional poorest-country window
IDA	Concessional credits/grants for eligible poorer countries	Eligibility differs from membership
IFC	Private-sector finance and mobilisation	Ordinary model lacks sovereign guarantee
MIGA	Political-risk insurance/credit enhancement	Not a lender or dispute tribunal
ICSID	Consent-based investment dispute settlement	India is not a Contracting State
ADB	Asia-Pacific regional development bank	Distinct from AIIB
AIIB	Multilateral sustainable-infrastructure bank	Approved members and full accession differ
NDB	BRICS-founded infrastructure/sustainable-development bank	Prospective members are not full members
BIS	Central-bank cooperation and banking services	Not a global central bank
BCBS	Prudential banking standards	No direct supranational legal force
FSB	System-wide financial-stability coordination	Recommendations need national implementation
G20	Informal political coordination	No treaty or permanent secretariat

Current-number controls

- IMF: 191 members; India quota SDR 13,114.4 million and voting share 2.63 percent.
- 16th Review: 50 percent equiproportional increase remained below the 85 percent consent threshold on 29 April 2026; deadline 15 November 2026.
- ADB: 69 members, 50 regional; India 6.317 percent shares and 5.343 percent votes at 31 December 2025.
- AIIB: 111 approved members; India 8.5702 percent subscription and 7.5268 percent voting power at cutoff.
- NDB: ten full members; India USD 10 billion subscription, 18.72 percent of subscribed capital.
- IBRD 189 members; IFC 186; MIGA 182; ICSID 158 Contracting States/166 signatories in August 2026.

Mains reform architecture

1. Diagnose liquidity, solvency, development or regulatory-coordination failure.
2. Match institution, client and instrument.
3. State governance: quota/share votes, boards, consensus or peer pressure.
4. Trace finance or standard through domestic implementation.
5. Evaluate ownership, safeguards, procurement, debt and distribution.
6. Test additionality and measurable development outcomes.
7. Propose voice reform, capital adequacy, faster delivery and accountability together.

8. Conclude that multilateral institutions coordinate sovereigns; they do not replace them.

Final boundaries

- WTO rules and trade negotiations belong to Topic 20.
- Reserve composition and exchange-rate operations belong to Topic 19.
- Basel capital ratios and Indian bank implementation belong to Topic 6.
- Infrastructure project-model detail belongs to Topic 18.
- Climate-finance depth belongs to Topic 25.